Half Done, Half Deferred

A Real Scorecard for Saudi Arabia's Vision 2030

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Nine years into Vision 2030, the Saudi government's 2025 Annual Report self-reports that 93% of headline KPIs have been achieved or are near target (Saudi Vision 2030 2026). Strip out the 52 indicators classed as "near" (85-99%), and the strict ≥100% achievement rate falls to 79.2%. The May 2025 publication of GASTAT's rebased National Accounts (chain-linked from a 2023 base) lifted the headline non-oil GDP share from roughly 50% to 76% — and cross-source readings on the same indicator span 30.7 percentage points. The Saudi-national unemployment target, originally set at 7%, was raised to 5% after the original was met. Three layers of accounting overhaul, layered together, have systematically amplified the narrative success of Vision 2030 in the headline numbers.

This study sets aside the elasticity of GDP accounting and tests Saudi Arabia's real oil dependence against three hard metrics that are insulated from GDP-base revisions: fiscal balance, export composition, and labour markets. Nine years on, all three have barely moved. What Vision 2030 has genuinely changed is the trajectory of the Kingdom, not the contents of its target list. Four areas constitute real reform: female labour force participation, social opening, financial-sector modernisation, and the tourism / pilgrimage hub. Four areas are either materially descoped or substantially behind: the NEOM and Giga-projects pipeline, the non-oil exports / non-oil GDP target, the SME share of GDP target, and the private-sector contribution to GDP. Under the three oil-price scenarios constructed in §6, Vision 2030's residual five-year KPI completion rate is set to land in a 60% to 80% range, with Brent oil price the single largest determinant. A "soft landing" mechanism is now visibly in place. Vision 2030 will not fail — but the actual end-state will look quite different from the 2016 announcement.

Keywords: Vision 2030, Saudi Arabia, economic diversification, PIF, NEOM

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1 Introduction

Saudi Vision 2030 launched nine years ago, and 2026 marks the beginning of its third and final implementation phase. The 2025 Annual Report self-reports that 93% of headline KPIs have been achieved or are on track (Saudi Vision 2030 2026). That figure combines 309 indicators classed as "achieved or exceeded interim targets" with 52 classed as "near target" (85-99%), out of 390 measured indicators. Applying the strict ≥100% threshold alone, the achievement rate is 79.2% — a 14-percentage-point gap between the two readings.

The divergence is not isolated. GASTAT's comprehensive revision of the National Accounts, adopted at the beginning of 2024 and published in May 2025, switched the base year from 2018 to 2023 and moved real GDP onto a chain-linked methodology. Under the same methodology, the non-oil share of GDP moved from roughly 72% to 76%. Cross-source readings on the same indicator span 30.7 percentage points: SAMA's 49.9% (old-base, pre-revision), the Vision 2030 office's "more than half" (~55%, paraphrased in media coverage), the IMF's 76% (rebased, including net taxes on products), and the GASTAT nominal back-calculation of 80.6% (GASTAT 2025a; SAMA 2024b; Saudi Vision 2030 2026; IMF 2025). GASTAT's own FAQ accompanying the revision states explicitly that one of its motivations is "to reflect the major structural transformations resulting from the implementation of Vision 2030" (GASTAT 2025b). Carnegie's March 2025 independent assessment was titled "Vision 2030 in the Home Stretch: Clear Achievements yet Limited Accountability" (Carnegie Endowment for International Peace 2025) — and that summary captures the asymmetry.

A third layer sits in the target architecture itself. The IMF Working Paper of January 2026 documents that Saudi Arabia's original Vision 2030 target for the Saudi-national unemployment rate was 7%; after that target was met in Q4 2024, the government raised it to 5% (Koll et al. 2026). This is the clearest documented case of "moving the goalposts" in the Vision 2030 KPI architecture. Layered with the GDP rebasing and the dual KPI-achievement framing, the headline narrative has been systematically amplified relative to the underlying delivery. The real tests over the remaining five years lie in the execution gap on the NEOM-class Giga-projects, the fiscal squeeze created by PIF's domestic funding requirements, and whether the two hardest structural KPIs — non-oil export intensity and SME GDP share — can break through.

This study classifies 16 core KPIs into five status bands: achieved (2), near target (4), on track (5), redefined (1), and lagging (4); the full breakdown and three-scenario assessment appear in §6. The argument proceeds as follows. §1 sets GDP accounting aside and tests oil dependence against three hard metrics: fiscal balance, export composition, and labour markets. §2 examines the substance behind non-oil growth and the role of government as the funding mechanism. §3 maps the boundary of fiscal sustainability. §4 traces the inflection point in PIF and the Giga-projects. §5 covers the four areas where social reform has outrun economic diversification. §6 synthesises the residual five-year reachability under three oil-price scenarios. Methodology and multi-source caliper notes are placed in Appendix A.

2 Three hard metrics on Saudi Arabia's real oil dependence

The central question of economic diversification is not "what is the non-oil share of GDP?", because the answer to that depends heavily on accounting choices — four sources span 30.7 percentage points, from SAMA's 49.9% (old base) to GASTAT's 80.6% (nominal back-calculation), and the May 2025 GASTAT revision lifted the IMF same-methodology figure from 72% to 76%. The real questions are three: has fiscal exposure to oil-price volatility narrowed; has the export basket actually de-oiled; has labour-market dependence on oil's indirect demand declined. These three "hard metrics" read directly from cash flows, customs data, and labour-force data, and are insulated from GDP-base revisions. This section walks through each in turn. The conclusion: in nine years, all three have barely moved.

2.1 The accounting consequences of GASTAT's May 2025 GDP rebasing

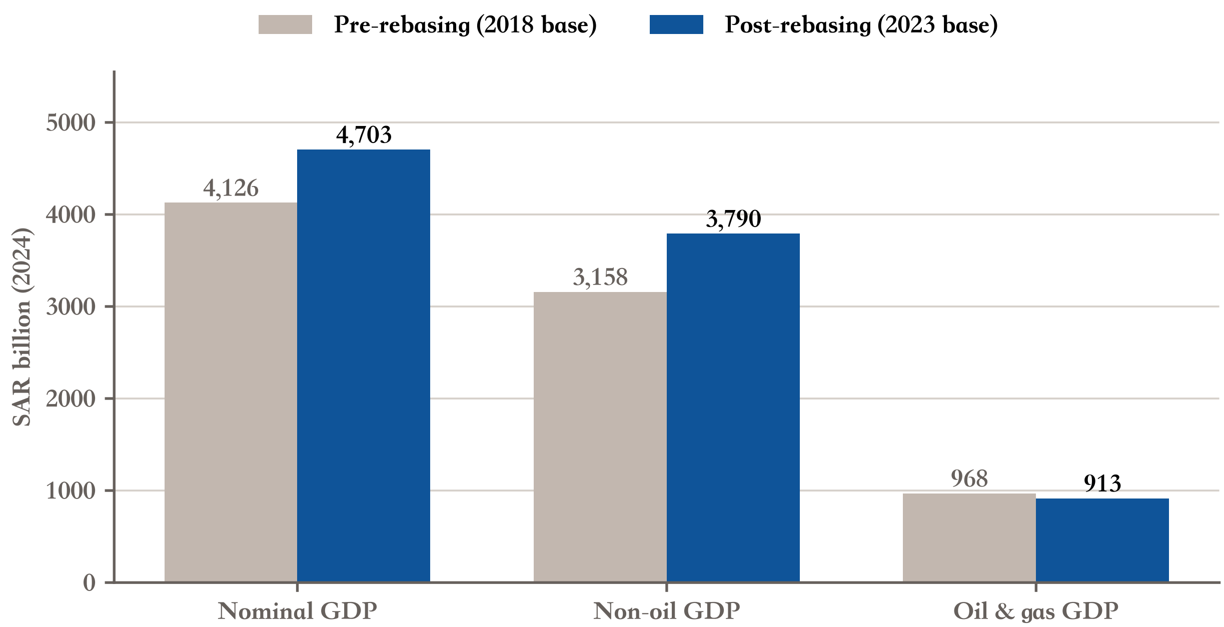
Before testing the three hard metrics, the GDP-level accounting change has to be cleared up — and the reason it cannot bail out real dependence has to be made explicit.

GASTAT's Annual National Accounts Publication 2024 (GASTAT 2025a), released in May 2025, completed a comprehensive revision involving three technical changes. First, the base year moved from 2018 to 2023. Second, real GDP was switched to a chain-linked methodology, aligning Saudi national accounts with the 2008 SNA standard. Third, the industry-level granularity expanded from a 85×85 input-output matrix to roughly 300×300, covering 134 economic activities. The result: 2024 nominal GDP was revised up by 14%, non-oil GDP by 20%, and the non-oil share of GDP (including net taxes on products) moved from roughly 72% pre-revision to 76% post-revision.

GASTAT's accompanying FAQ candidly states the motivation (GASTAT 2025b). Question 2 ("Why undertake a comprehensive revision?") answers that the revision is meant to "reflect the major structural transformations resulting from the implementation of Vision 2030 initiatives"; Question 3 adds that the revision "provides a more reliable basis for tracking the country's economic goals." In other words, the GDP methodology upgrade is directly linked to the measurement needs of Vision 2030 KPIs. The linkage itself is not a conspiracy — the IMF had repeatedly recommended a National Accounts methodology upgrade through technical-assistance missions between 2019 and 2024 — but when the same-methodology IMF figure moves from 72% to 76% (a defensible

4-percentage-point upward revision under the new methodology), layered on top of a cross-source 30.7-ppt span from 49.9% to 80.6%, media coverage tends to substitute one figure for another, and the narrative is amplified.

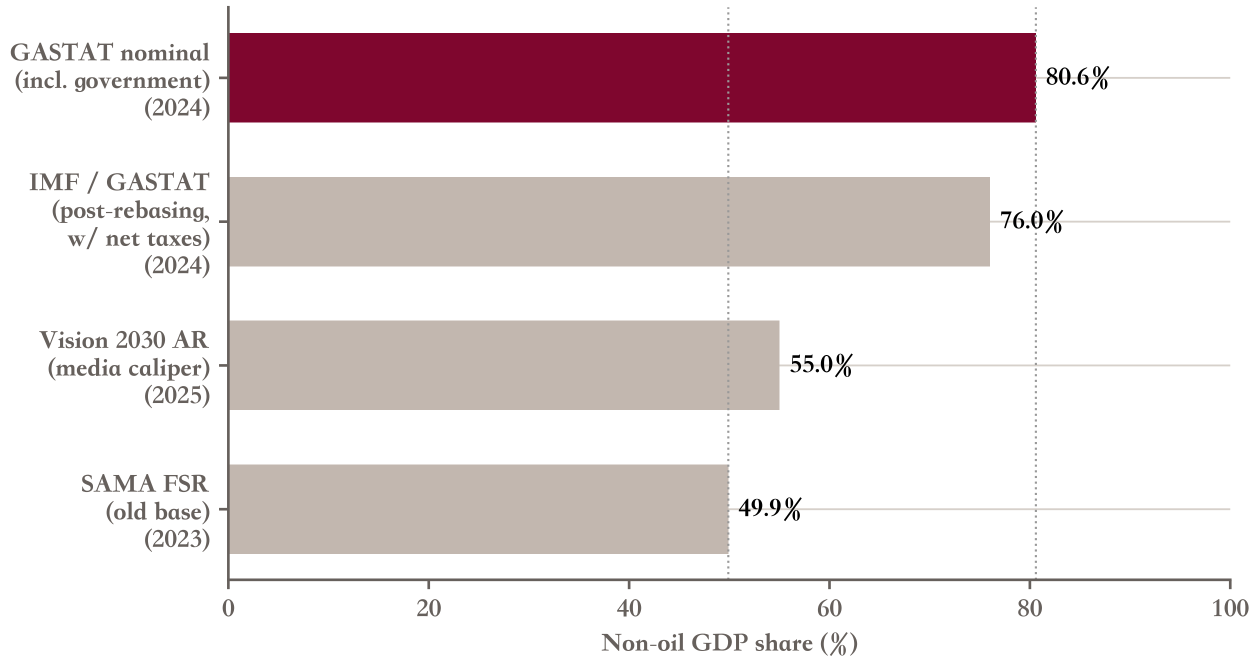
Figure 1: Accounting impact of the GDP rebasing, before vs after



Source: GASTAT Annual National Accounts Publication 2024. Note: non-oil GDP includes the government sector and net taxes on products; post-rebasing uses the new 2023 base and chain-linked methodology; prior-period figures are back-calculated by the published revision magnitude.

The non-oil share of GDP is a single indicator with four very different readings. SAMA's 2024 Financial Stability Report records 49.9% for 2023 (old base, excluding government, inferred caliper) (SAMA 2024b); the Vision 2030 Annual Report 2025 and media coverage cite "more than half" or approximately 55% (a media paraphrase rather than a verbatim Vision 2030 figure) (Saudi Vision 2030 2026); the IMF's 2025 Article IV report, Box 1 "New Methodology of National Account Statistics," puts the post-rebasing non-oil share at 76% (including net taxes on products) (IMF 2025); GASTAT's own annual report shows oil at 19.4% of nominal GDP, back-calculating to a non-oil share of 80.6% (nominal caliper, including a government share of 7.4%) (GASTAT 2025a). When any "non-oil share" figure appears, the question is not "is this number correct" but "which caliper produced it".

Figure 2: Non-oil GDP share: four sources, 30.7-percentage-point range



Source: SAMA FSR 2024 / Vision 2030 AR 2025 / IMF Article IV 2025 / GASTAT NA 2024. Note: the caliper differences are driven by four variables —whether net taxes on products are included, nominal vs constant prices, the old 2018 base vs new 2023 base, and whether the government sector is included.

The four caliper drivers are: whether net taxes on products are included, nominal vs constant prices, the old 2018 base vs the new 2023 base, and whether the government sector is included. Every "non-oil share" figure in this study from this point onward names the source, the caliper, and the year — leaving the reader to judge.

The more important point is that the GDP-share indicator, taken on its own as a proxy for diversification progress, may not be very reliable. The reason is in the next three sections: fiscal, export, and labour-market hard metrics are unaffected by GDP-base revisions.

2.2 Fiscal hard metric: the fiscal breakeven oil price has risen from \$76 to \$92

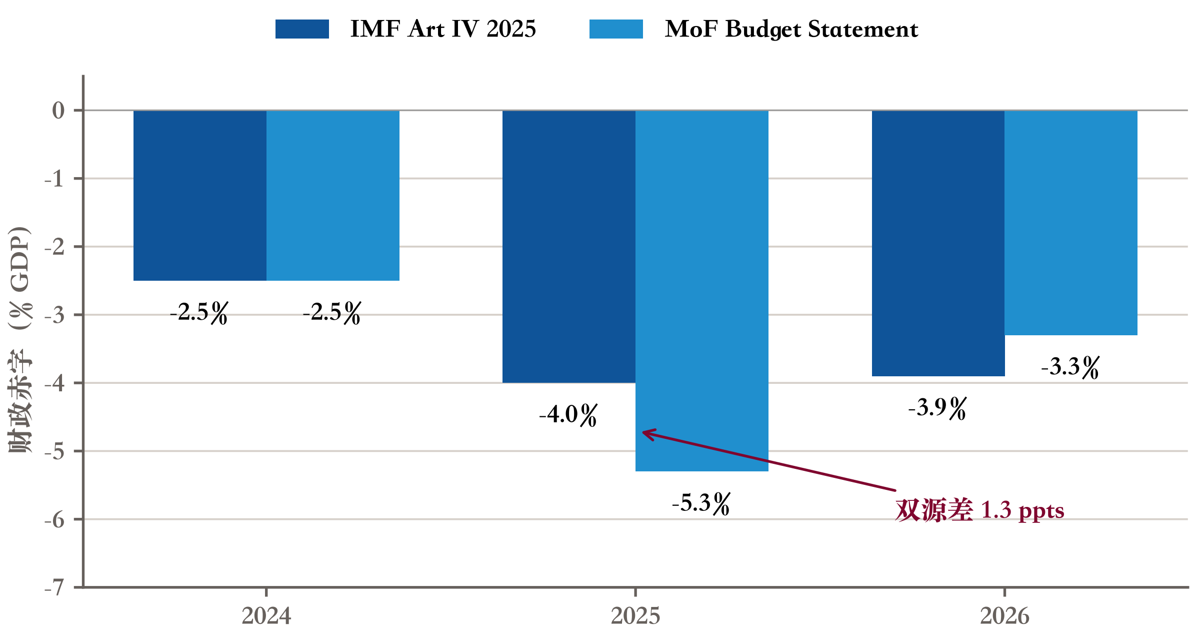
Fiscal exposure to oil prices is the Saudi government's real pain point, and the accounting changes cannot rescue it.

The IMF's 2025 Article IV report puts the fiscal breakeven oil price at \$92/barrel (IMF 2025) — meaning that any time Brent prints below \$92, the Saudi budget runs a deficit. When Vision 2030 launched in 2016, the contemporaneous market framing implied a 2030 breakeven target of around \$48. The locally-held Vision 2030 Executive Summary PDF is the 2025 reissue (the 2016 original cannot be directly verified from the local copy), but the 2025 reissue no longer mentions that specific figure — which can be read as the target having quietly been retired from the official narrative. Nine years of reform have moved the breakeven from roughly $76 in 2016 to $92 in 2025, in precisely the wrong direction. The reason is structural: Vision 2030 itself (PIF and the Giga-projects in particular) requires large-scale government spending to launch, and the fiscal breakeven moves up to match.

Goldman Sachs in April 2025 sketched a specific scenario: if Brent holds around $62 in 2025, the Saudi fiscal deficit could roughly double from $30.8 billion in 2024 to $70-75 billion (Goldman Sachs Research 2025).

The Saudi Ministry of Finance's own data is more pessimistic than the IMF's. In its FY 2026 Budget Statement issued in December 2025, MoF placed its FY 2025 deficit estimate at 5.3% of GDP (Saudi Ministry of Finance 2025) — materially higher than the IMF Article IV's same-period 4.0% projection, a 1.3-percentage-point gap. The likely explanation is the data timing: MoF's read is later (FY 2025 had passed Q3), whereas the IMF report was completed in July 2025, so MoF was operating with more visible negative signals.

Figure 3: Deficit, MoF vs IMF dual-source comparison

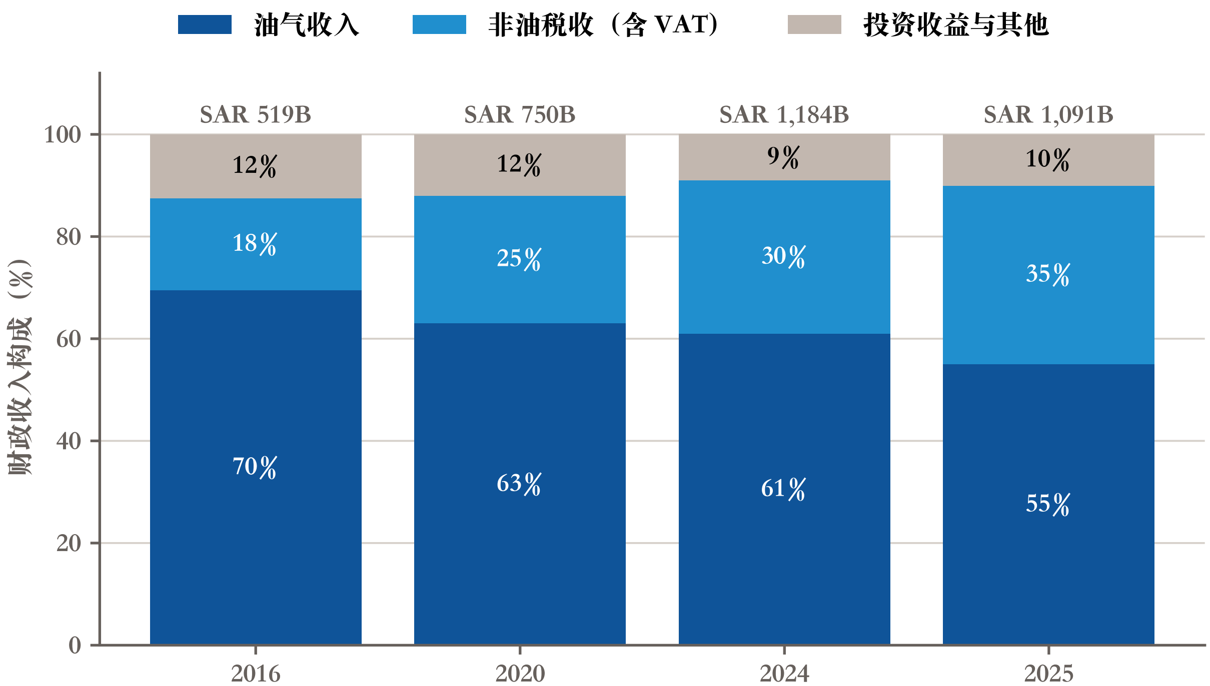


Source: IMF Article IV 2025 (CR 25/223 Table 1) / MoF FY 2025 + FY 2026 Budget Statements. Note: MoF FY 2025 deficit estimate of 5.3

On public debt, the two sources are closer. The IMF's 2025 figure for public debt / GDP is 29.8%, 2026E 32.6% (IMF 2025); MoF's FY 2026 Budget gives 31.7% for 2025 and 32.7% for 2026 (Saudi Ministry of Finance 2025) — a 1.9-ppt gap in the same direction, reflecting greater convergence on the debt trajectory.

The fiscal revenue mix is shifting. VAT was introduced in 2018 at 5% and tripled to 15% in 2020. Combined with tighter corporate tax administration and growing customs receipts, non-oil tax revenue's share of total fiscal revenue has moved from about 18% in 2016 to about 30% in 2024 — a genuine Vision 2030 reform. But oil revenue still accounts for 55-60% (2024 actual), and once investment income (PIF plus SAMA reserves) is added, total exposure to oil prices has not measurably narrowed.

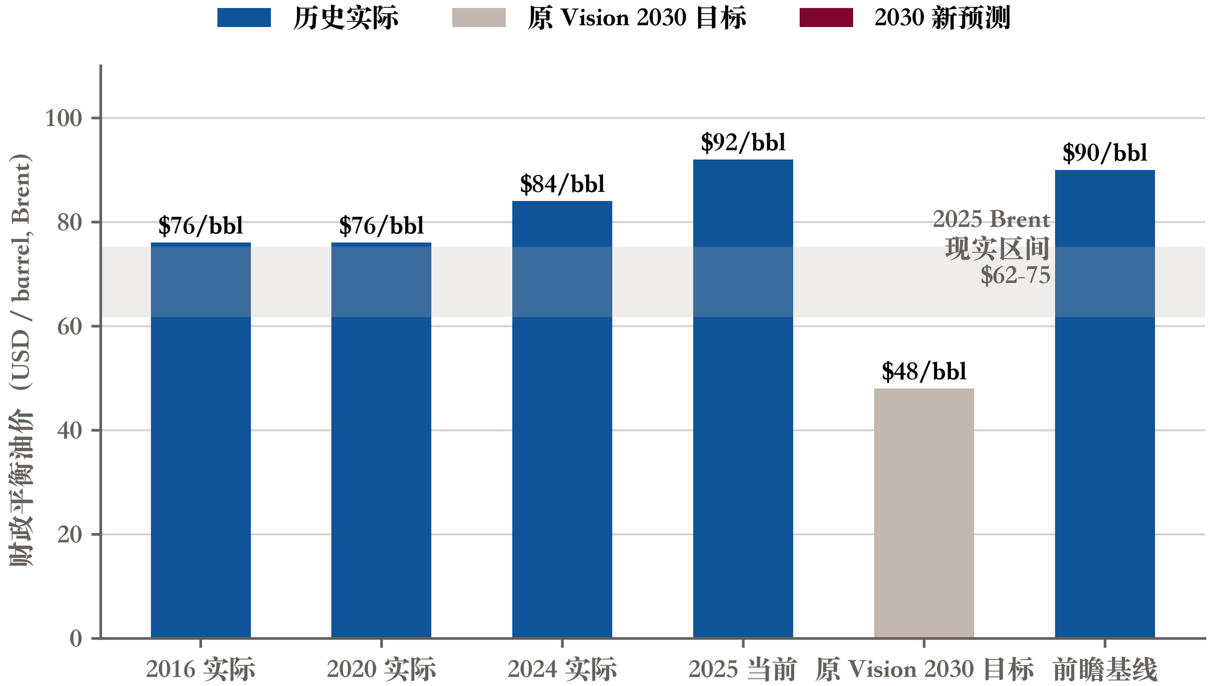
Figure 4: Fiscal revenue composition, 2016 to 2025



Source: IMF Article IV 2025 / MoF FY 2025-2026 Budget Statements. Note: percentages of total fiscal revenue; non-oil taxes include VAT (introduced 2018, tripled to 15

The breakeven trajectory tells the same story. When oil prices collapsed in 2016, the breakeven was around \$76. During COVID in 2020 it stayed at \$76, recovered to \$84 in 2024, and reached \$92 in 2025. Structural spending growth keeps pushing the breakeven up, and the original Vision 2030 \$48 target is no longer mentioned in its own narrative.

Figure 5: Fiscal breakeven oil price, historical evolution



Source: IMF Article IV 2025 / Vision 2030 Executive Summary 2016 / Bloomberg / GS. Note: IMF fiscal breakeven excluding PIF domestic spending; Bloomberg's PIF-inclusive figure is approximately $111, JPM's approximately $98; the $62-75 "current price" range covers the broad envelope of the 2025 Brent futures curve.

2.3 Export hard metric: oil and oil products still account for 77%, the hardest structure to shift

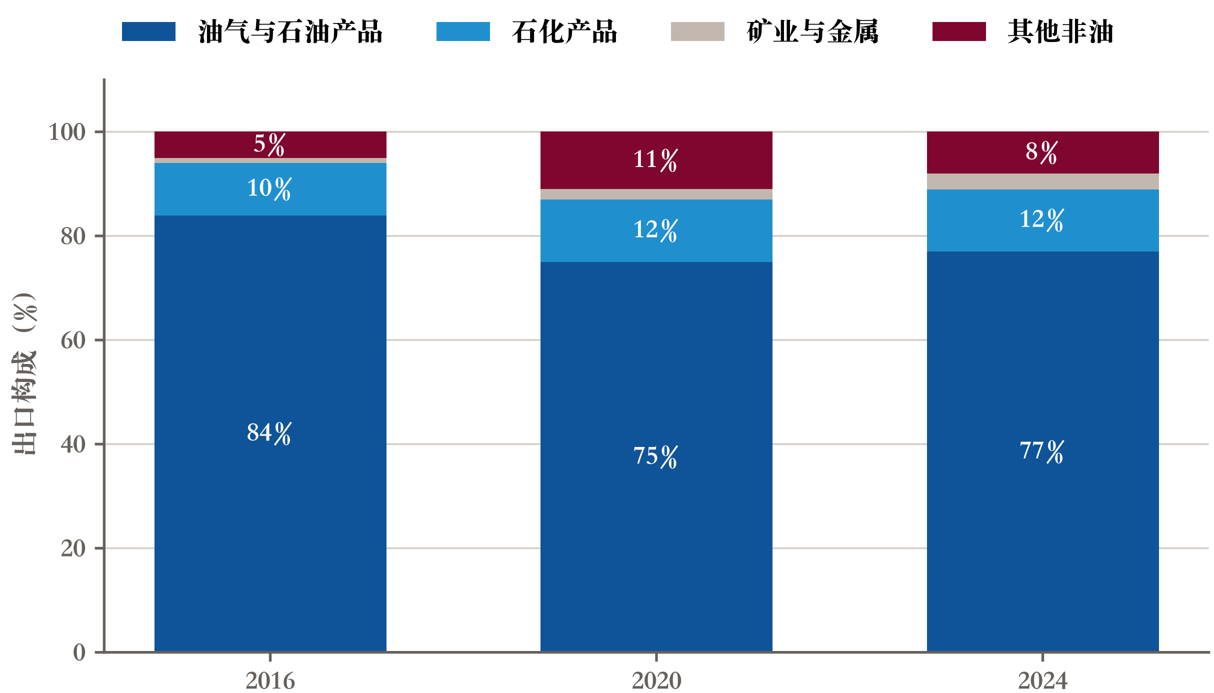
Export composition is among the weakest-performing Vision 2030 indicators, with almost no movement in nine years.

Two calipers on export structure are independent and must be stated separately to avoid confusion. The first is the degree of de-oiling of the export basket. The IMF's 2025 Article IV report, on page 5, "Selected Economic Indicators," explicitly states: "Main products and exports: Oil and oil products (77%)" (IMF 2025) — meaning 77% of Saudi exports in 2024 are still oil, refined products, and petrochemicals. Nine years on, this number has barely changed — direct evidence that export-basket de-oiling has stalled.

The second is the Vision 2030 official KPI of "non-oil exports / non-oil GDP" — note that the denominator is non-oil GDP, not total exports. The Vision 2030 Annual Report 2025, page 23, gives the KPI explicitly: baseline 16.9%, 2025 actual 22.14%, 2030 target 50% (Saudi Vision 2030 2026). The 2025 interim target was 38%, which the 22.14% actual missed by a wide margin. Nine years have moved the indicator from 16.9% to 22.14%; the gap to the 2030 target is 27.86 percentage points, meaning the remaining five years would need to more than double the share.

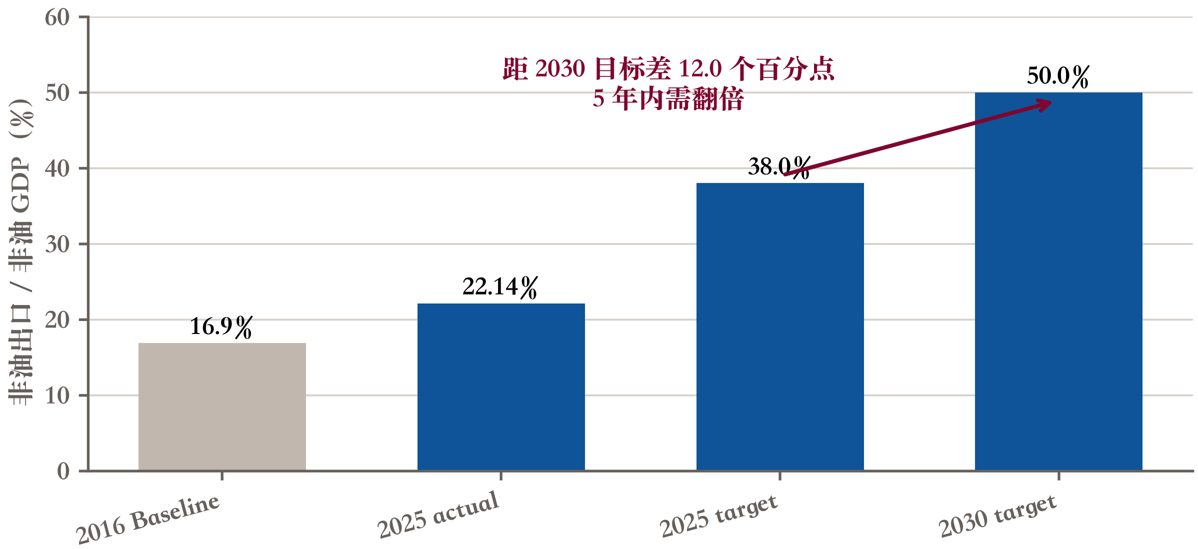
The two calipers are not interchangeable. The first answers “is the export basket de-oiling?” — the answer is barely. The second answers “can non-oil exports scale relative to the non-oil economy base?” — the answer is slowly, but nowhere near enough. Every reference in this report names the caliper.

Figure 6: Saudi Arabia export composition, 2016 / 2020 / 2024



Source: IMF Article IV 2025 p.5; GASTAT trade statistics. Note: some 2016 / 2020 sub-category figures are estimates; the original Shareek target was a 50

Figure 7: Non-oil exports share, time series



Source: Vision 2030 Annual Report 2025 p.23 (KPI = Share of Non-Oil Exports in Non-Oil GDP). Note: the official KPI denominator is non-oil GDP, not total exports. Export-basket oil intensity is discussed separately in §1.3 main text. The 22.14

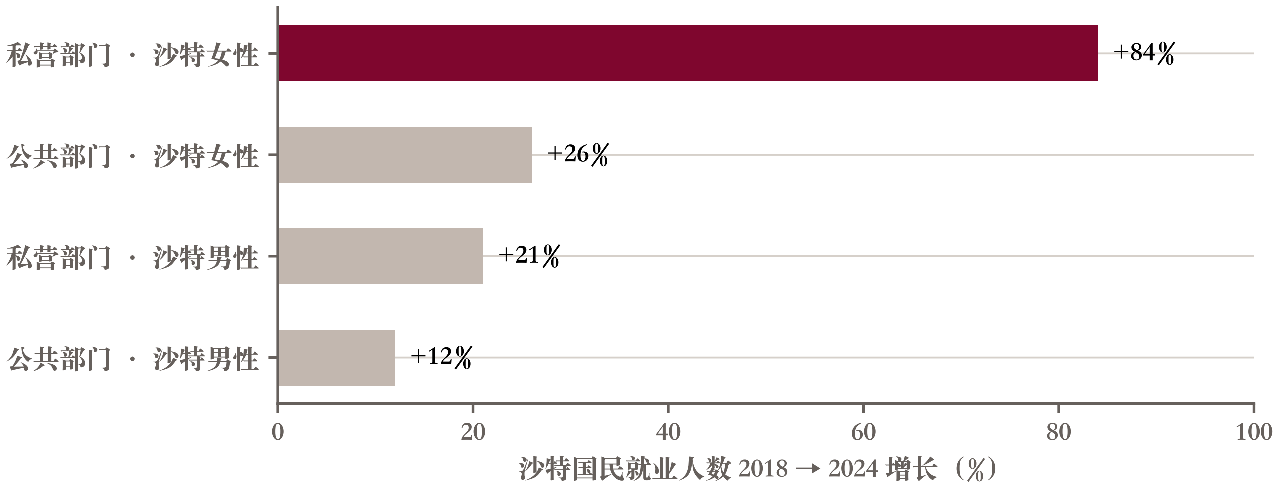
The reason export structure is hard to shift is physical, not political. Exports have to be either oil (which Saudi Arabia has by nature), petrochemicals (where cheap-feedstock advantages exist), manufacturing (where Saudi competitiveness is limited compared to China / Japan / Korea), or services (tourism and pilgrimage are already counted, but at limited scale). Accounting rebasing cannot rescue the export caliper, because export figures come directly from customs data and have no interpretive elasticity.

2.4 Labour hard metric: private-sector Saudi women employment up 84% is real reform

There is a genuine reform on the labour-market side.

The IMF Working Paper of January 2026 disaggregates Saudi-national employment growth by sector and gender (Koll et al. 2026). Between 2018 and 2024, employment of Saudi women in the private sector grew by approximately 84%, and Saudi men in the private sector by approximately 21%; in the public sector, Saudi women +26%, Saudi men +12%. (The +84% rate is derived from Figure 18 in the paper, "Public and Private Sector Employment by Gender"; the paper's prose states only the aggregate that "since 2020, nearly 700,000 Saudis have joined the private sector workforce.") The private × female combination at +84% is the most uncontestable real achievement of Vision 2030.

Figure 8: Saudi national employment growth, 2018-2024



Source: IMF Working Paper 2026/14 (Koll, Medici, Tavares & Saito), Figure 18 "Public and Private Sector Employment by Gender." Note: Saudi nationals only (excluding expatriate workers); private-sector growth includes both Saudization quota policy and new tourism-sector jobs; +84

But the degree of de-oiling in labour-market structure has to be discounted. A substantial portion of Saudi private-sector employment still serves indirect oil demand: engineering contractors serving Aramco, accounting firms serving PIF projects, logistics companies hauling materials to NEOM sites. A decline in direct oil employment is not the same as a structural de-oiling of the economy. Ismail's 2010 IMF Working Paper, using Saudi manufacturing data from 1977 to 2004, concluded that "capital-intensive manufacturing is less exposed to oil price shocks; diversifying the capital intensity of manufacturing is a buffer" (Ismail 2010). Looking only at the head-count overstates Saudi de-oiling progress; the capital-intensity structure of employment is the better diagnostic. This framework reappears in §2 and §6.

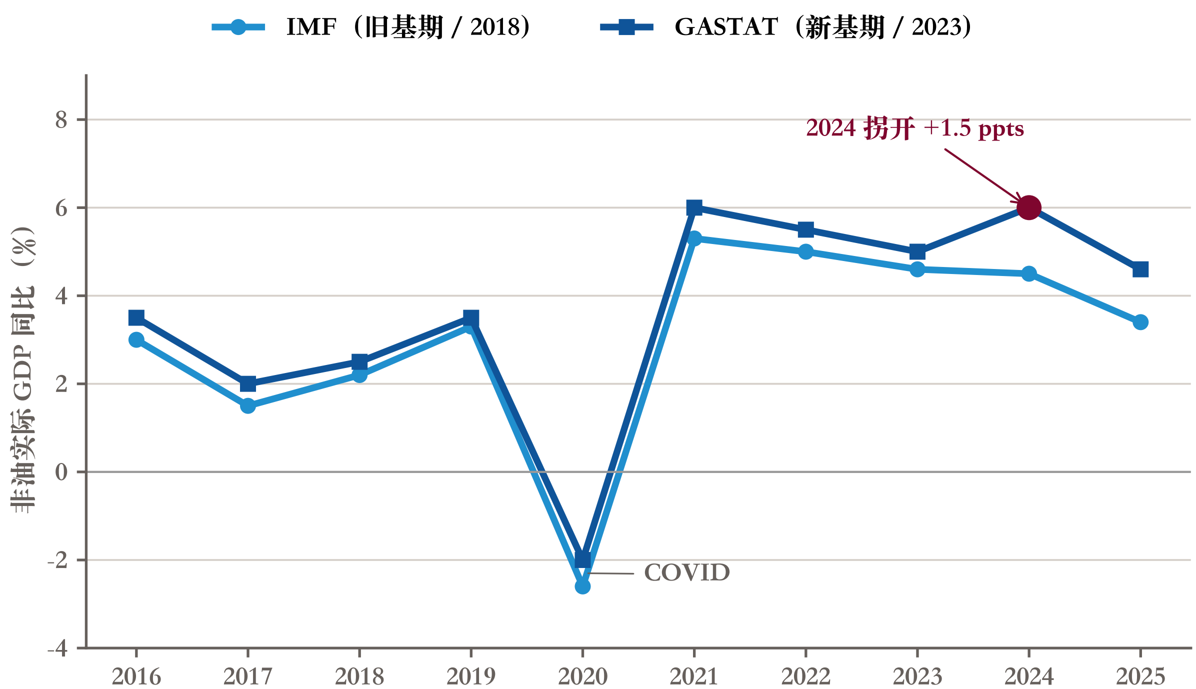
3 The government's role in non-oil growth

The non-oil GDP growth rate itself is not in doubt. The IMF puts 2024 non-oil growth at 4.5%, GASTAT puts it at 6.0% (under the rebased methodology) — two different calipers, both pointing to fast growth. The structural question is where the growth is coming from. This study estimates that approximately 70% of recent non-oil growth is government-led, including PIF injections, Vision 2030 project contracts, public-sector wage growth, and Shareek-channelled private investment (which is fundamentally a private-sector response to government-led orders). This section first reconciles the IMF-vs-GASTAT growth-rate gap, then unpacks the sector mix, then assesses PIF's contribution mechanism, and finally examines the "middle" — the SME sector.

3.1 IMF 3.4% vs GASTAT 4.5-4.9%: explaining the 1-percentage-point gap

The IMF Article IV 2025 Table 1 puts Saudi non-oil GDP growth at 4.5% for 2024, 3.4% for 2025E, 3.5% for 2026E (IMF 2025). GASTAT's Q1-Q3 2025 high-frequency data shows non-oil growth running in the 4.5% to 4.9% range, and the full-year 2024 (post-rebasing) at +6.0% (GASTAT 2025a). The two sources differ by more than a percentage point.

Figure 9: Non-oil GDP growth: IMF vs GASTAT dual-source time series



Source: IMF Article IV Saudi Arabia 2025 (pre-rebasing); GASTAT Annual National Accounts 2024 (post-rebasing). Note: real GDP year-on-year growth; the IMF series uses the 2018 base, GASTAT uses the 2023 base + chain-linked methodology.

The gap has two layers. The first is technical: the IMF data is more conservative because it combines annual estimates and projection adjustments and partly uses pre-revision historical data; GASTAT is rolling quarterly with seasonal adjustment and the new post-revision methodology. The second is the May 2025 rebasing itself, which lifted 2024 non-oil GDP by 20% — a defensible upward revision on the basis of base-year change, but when layered onto a "growth rate" calculation it also pushes up the 2024 year-on-year number. Both are correct, and each is for a different use case: cite the IMF for forward-looking framing (caliper stability), cite GASTAT for the most recent actuals (first-party, most current). The report needs to present them side by side.

3.2 Sector mix: is construction +61% NEOM excitement or real growth?

In GASTAT's 2024 sector growth data, construction is the standout: +61%. The four sector groupings: construction +61%, retail / hotels / food services +29.8%, logistics / telecommunications +25.6%, financial sector +8.5%.

Construction's +61% is heavily concentrated in PIF and Vision 2030 project contracts. Roshn (housing), Diriyah (cultural tourism), NEOM (infrastructure) contracts cluster in 2023-2024 award years. This is a textbook example of "government-order-driven growth" with low replicability. Once the Giga-projects start to descope (see §4), construction growth will fall back rapidly.

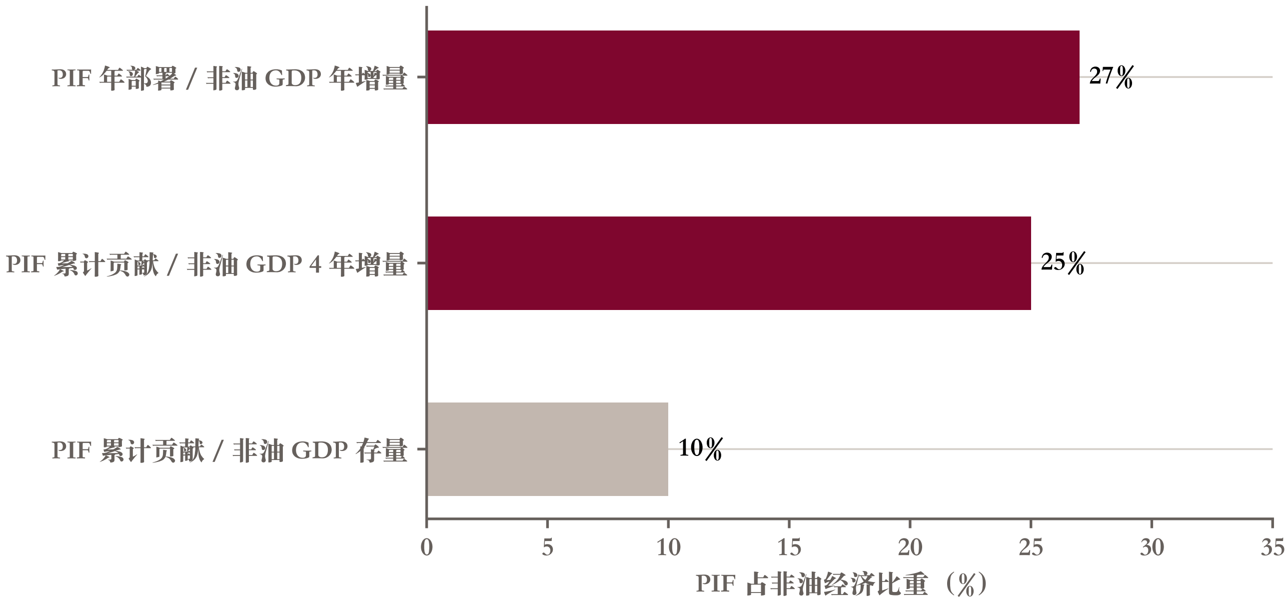
Retail / hotels / food services +29.8% is more sustainable. This growth comes from tourist-visa opening, domestic consumption upgrades, and the household-disposable-income lift driven by female employment growth. Logistics / telecommunications +25.6% sits between the two: part comes from Vision 2030 infrastructure (Saudi regional logistics hub) and part from market demand (e-commerce, digitalisation). Financial sector +8.5% is FSDP-driven and relatively stable (see §5).

3.3 PIF as the engine: 10% of the stock, 25% of the increment

PIF self-reports that its cumulative contribution to Saudi non-oil GDP between 2021 and 2024 was SAR 910 billion (PIF 2025), roughly $243 billion at prevailing FX.

How should this be read? Under a stock caliper, PIF's cumulative contribution represents about 10% of current non-oil GDP — consistent with PIF's own 2024 disclosure that it "accounts for about 10% of Saudi non-oil economy." Under an increment caliper, PIF's cumulative contribution represents about 25% of the new non-oil GDP added over the past four years. In other words, of every four Saudi riyals of incremental non-oil GDP in the past four years, one came directly from PIF.

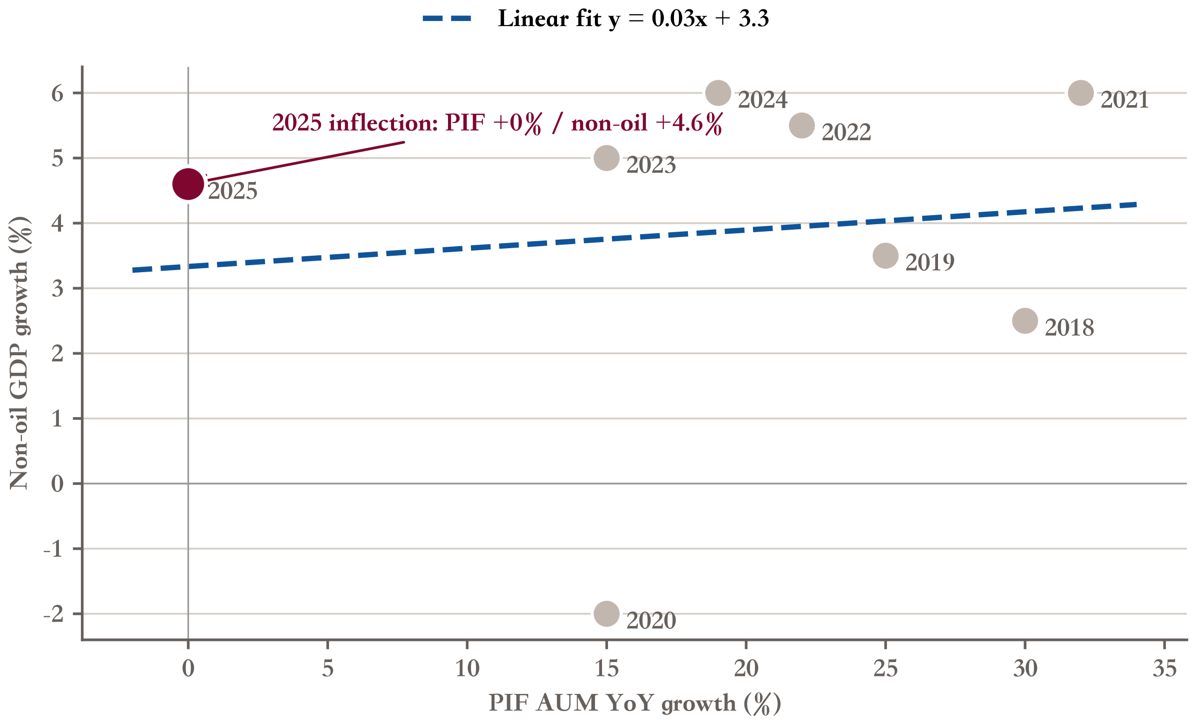
Figure 10: PIF share of non-oil economy: stock vs increment, dual caliper



Source: PIF Annual Report 2024 (cumulative non-oil GDP contribution SAR 910B / $243B); IMF Article IV 2025 + GASTAT NA 2024. Note: the increment 25

This is a structural dependence. If PIF inflow slows, non-oil GDP growth loses an important driver. PIF AUM growth in 2025 already shifted from +19% to broadly stable (PIF 2025). Vision 2030 AR 2025 (page 21) confirms approximately $909 billion at end-2025, broadly stable year-on-year (Saudi Vision 2030 2026). A rough estimate: without PIF increment, non-oil growth would fall from 4.5-5% to 2.5-3%.

Figure 11: PIF AUM YoY vs non-oil GDP growth, scatter



Source: PIF Annual Reports 2018-2024; IMF / GASTAT non-oil GDP historical. Note: 2025 PIF AUM YoY ≈ 0

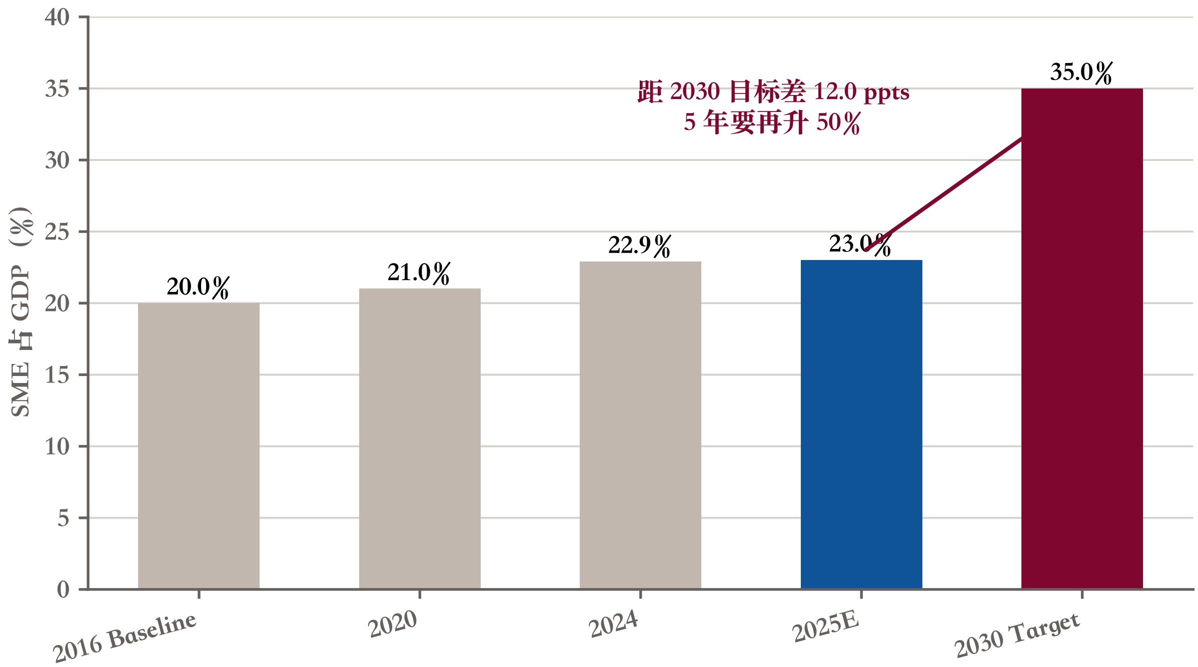
The 2018-2024 scatter shows that PIF AUM growth and non-oil GDP growth are positively correlated. This is not a simple causal relationship — oil prices and reform pace are common drivers — but the correlation does suggest a mechanism: PIF as a quasi-fiscal instrument generates non-oil GDP through its own expansion. Once PIF moves to broadly stable, the "government driver" for non-oil growth contracts.

3.4 SME share of GDP 22.9%, 12 percentage points short of the 35% target

The SME sector is a key indicator of structural health in the non-oil economy, and Saudi performance is middling.

The Vision 2030 Annual Report 2025 self-reports SME share of GDP at 22.9%, with 8.88 million people employed (Saudi Vision 2030 2026); the 2030 target is 35%. The gap is 12.1 percentage points, meaning the remaining 5 years would need SME share of GDP to rise by 50% — a pace rarely seen historically. In most countries, structural change in SME share of GDP takes 10 to 20 years.

Figure 12: SME share of GDP, time series



Source: Vision 2030 Executive Summary 2016 (baseline + target); Vision 2030 Annual Report 2025 p.21. Note: SME includes the combined GDP contribution of micro / small / medium enterprises (including sole proprietors).

A deeper issue is SME financing. The IMF Article IV 2025 page 9 reports SME loans as a share of total bank loans: 2016 baseline 2.0%, 2024 9.4%, 2030 target 20% (IMF 2025). Vision 2030 AR 2025 (page 23) updates this figure further: SME loans reached 11.3% in 2025, exceeding the 2025 interim target of 11% (Saudi Vision 2030 2026). From 2% in 2016 to 11.3% in 2025 is genuine reform — the Kafalah guarantee programme, dedicated SME bank credit lines, and the CMA's growth board (Nomu) all contributed — but 11.3% is still 8.7 percentage points short of the 2030 target. SME growth currently leans on government transfers and contracts rather than market-based financing, which means SMEs' "true private-sector character" is discounted.

4 The boundary of fiscal sustainability

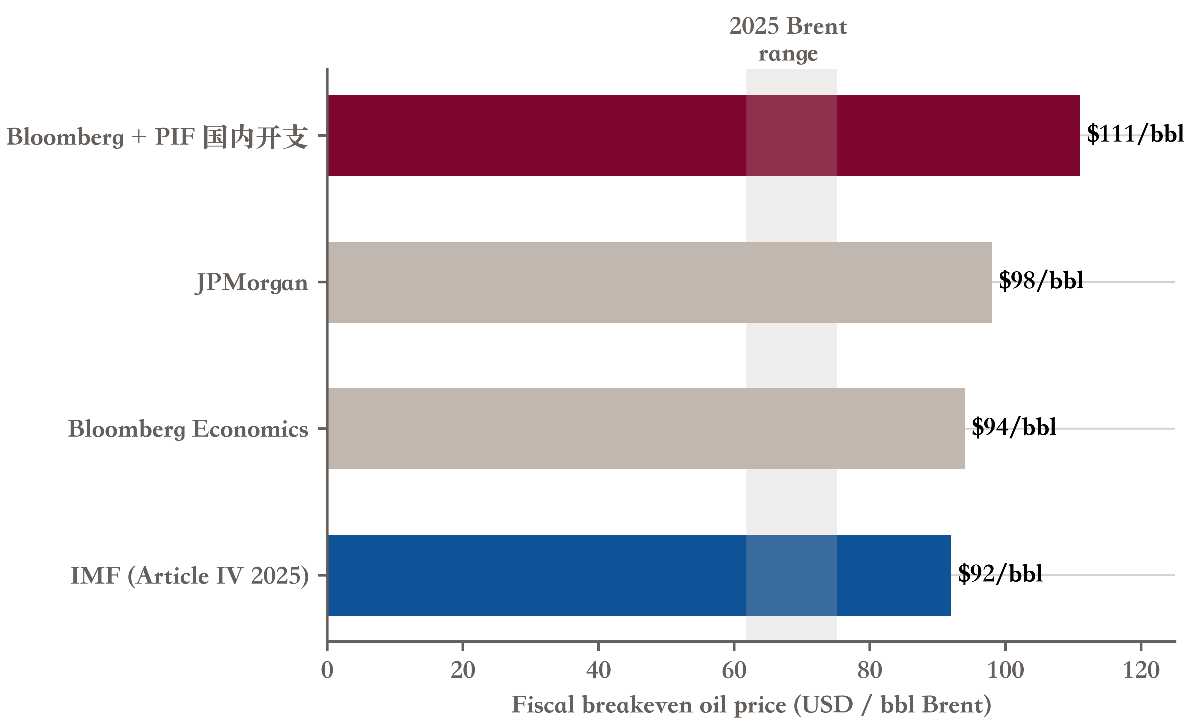
Fiscal sustainability has to be assessed on two layers: absolute level and direction. On absolute level, Saudi Arabia is healthy — public debt at 32.6% of GDP is well below the emerging-market average of around 70%, reserve months exceed 13, sovereign ratings hold steady at A+/Aa3. But all four indicators are moving in the wrong direction: public debt rising, external debt rising, twin deficits, reserve months declining. Above $80 oil there is no problem; $60-70 starts to press; $50 in the extreme scenario significantly raises the sovereign-rating downgrade risk. This section first compares the breakeven calipers across four sources, then traces the debt path, then sets up the three-scenario cumulative deficit, and finally clears up the reserves dual-caliper trap.

4.1 Fiscal breakeven, four sources: $19 between $92 and $111 driven by "with or without PIF"

The fiscal breakeven oil price is a deceptively simple concept that is in fact polysemous.

Four mainstream sources give four numbers. The IMF Article IV 2025 gives $92/bbl (caliper: full general government spending, excluding PIF domestic outlays) (IMF 2025). Bloomberg Economics is approximately $94, with a PIF-inclusive version of approximately $111 (cited repeatedly in Bloomberg's own coverage of its in-house analysis); JPMorgan's composite range is $96 to $98 (widely cited in market commentary; the single-point primary report was not obtained for this study). Subsequent discussion anchors on the IMF's $92, with Bloomberg / JPM providing directional reference. The spread is driven by two variables: whether PIF domestic spending is included, and whether quasi-fiscal spending (development funds etc.) is included. The strictest PIF-inclusive caliper of $111 implies that even if Brent recovers to $90, Saudi Arabia still runs a structural deficit. That is the real pressure.

Figure 13: Fiscal breakeven oil price, four-source comparison



Source: IMF anchor $92 (Art IV 2025); Bloomberg / Bloomberg+PIF / JPM figures via media citation - IMF Art IV 2025 / Bloomberg Economics / JPMorgan / Bloomberg + PIF caliper. Note: IMF uses "central-government primary balance"; Bloomberg includes some *quasi-fiscal items; JPM includes development funds; the PIF-inclusive caliper adds approximately $40B/year of PIF domestic funding requirement.*

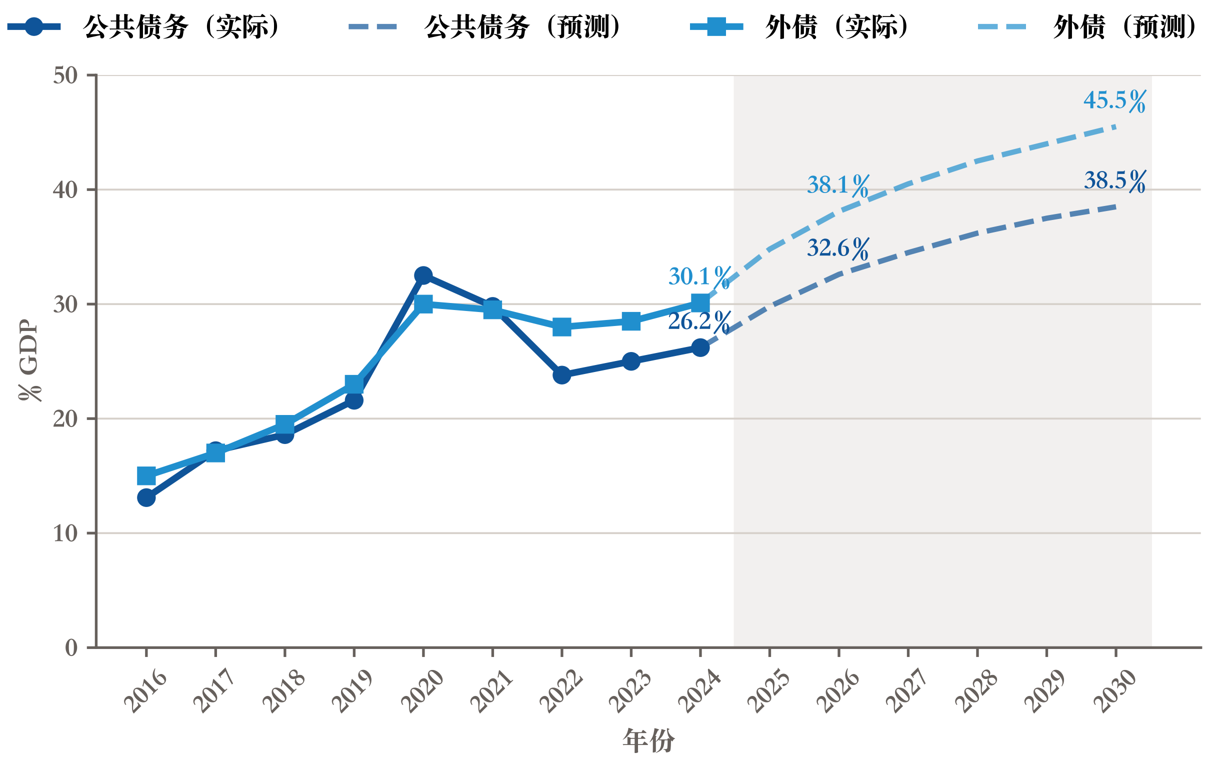
In subsequent discussion this report names the caliper when citing "fiscal breakeven." The default is the IMF $92 (excluding PIF) as anchor; the Bloomberg+PIF $111 is used as the upper bound when discussing PIF domestic-funding impact.

4.2 Public and external debt: cumulative 14-percentage-point rise over 3 years

The IMF Article IV 2025 Table 1 numbers are direct.

Public debt as a share of GDP: 26.2% (2024), 29.8% (2025E), 32.6% (2026E) — a cumulative rise of 6.4 percentage points over three years. External debt as a share of GDP: 30.1% (2024), 34.8% (2025E), 38.1% (2026E) — a cumulative rise of 8.0 percentage points. Combined: 14 percentage points.

Figure 14: Public + external debt time series, 2016 to 2030E

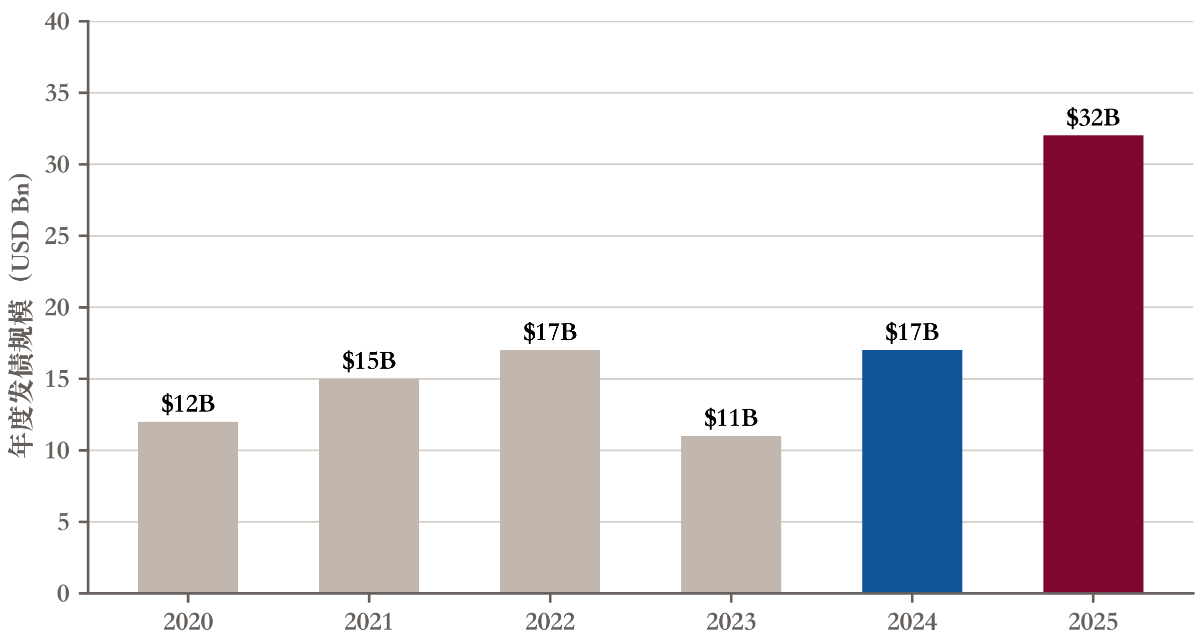


Source: IMF Article IV 2025 Table 1 + Annex VIII Sovereign Risk DSA; MoF FY 2026 Budget. Note: 2027-2030 are simple trend extrapolations by this study, not a full IMF medium-term DSA conclusion.

The absolute level remains low (emerging-market average is around 70%), but the pace of increase is faster than the IMF had previously expected, mainly because Vision 2030 project financing demands have layered on top of the deferred Aramco secondary offering (the original Aramco IPO proceeds were expected to absorb part of the fiscal pressure). MoF's FY 2026 Budget confirms 31.7% for 2025 and 32.7% for 2026 (Saudi Ministry of Finance 2025), close to the IMF.

Debt issuance is accelerating. PIF alone issued $9.8 billion in 2024 (PIF 2025), including the first GBP asset-liability-matching issue ($828M), $3.5B sukuk, $5.5B conventional bonds, a $15B revolving credit facility, and the first murabaha credit facility ($7B). Moody's upgraded PIF's long-term issuer rating to Aa3 (from A1) — rating agencies retain confidence in PIF, but the pace of issuance itself shows that PIF can no longer rely solely on government injections to sustain its expansion. Central government issuance in 2025 was materially larger than in 2024, with PIF and central government adding leverage in parallel.

Figure 15: Government + PIF annual debt issuance, 2020-2025



Source: NDMC (National Debt Management Centre) / Saudi MoF / PIF Annual Report 2024 / Zhitong Caijing 2025. Note: 2024 includes PIF's $9.8B (first GBP asset-liability matching + first murabaha + sukuk + conventional); 2025 is an estimate combining central government + PIF.

4.3 Three oil-price scenarios for cumulative deficit through 2030: a 5x spread

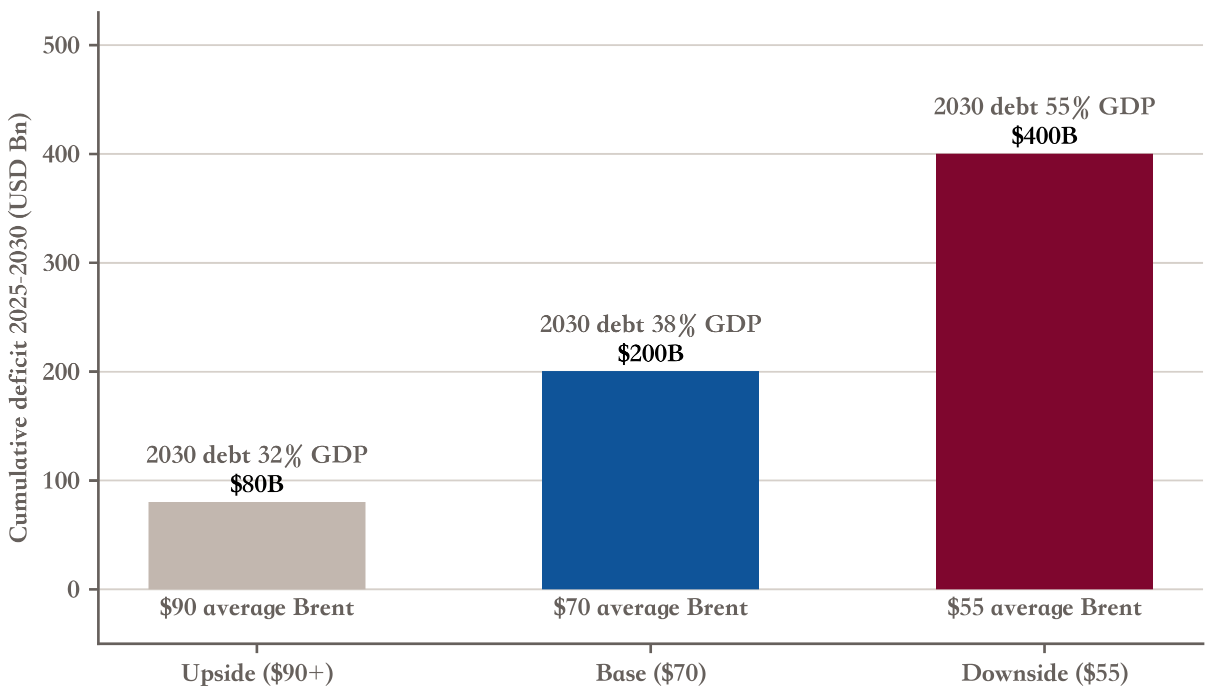
Combining IMF, GS, and JPM existing projections, a range can be put forward.

Base case, Brent average $70: cumulative deficit through 2025-2030 is approximately $200 billion, about 12% of 2030 nominal GDP — manageable; 2030 public debt around 38% of GDP.

Downside, Brent average $55: cumulative deficit jumps to approximately $400 billion; 2030 public debt could exceed 55% of GDP. This extends the IMF Annex VII "Lower Oil Price Scenario" and the April GS warning (IMF 2025; Goldman Sachs Research 2025). In this scenario, Saudi Arabia would trigger sovereign credit-rating downgrades, with material foreign-reserves drawdown.

Upside, Brent average $90+: cumulative deficit only $80 billion, 2030 public debt 32% of GDP, Vision 2030 fiscal headroom adequate.

Figure 16: Three oil-price scenarios: 2025-2030 cumulative deficit



Source: IMF Article IV 2025 Annex VII Lower Oil Price Scenario; GS Saudi deficit warning 2025-04; IMF medium-term consolidation path baseline. Note: this study does not build its own forecast model; this figure integrates the three institutions' published projections into a range.

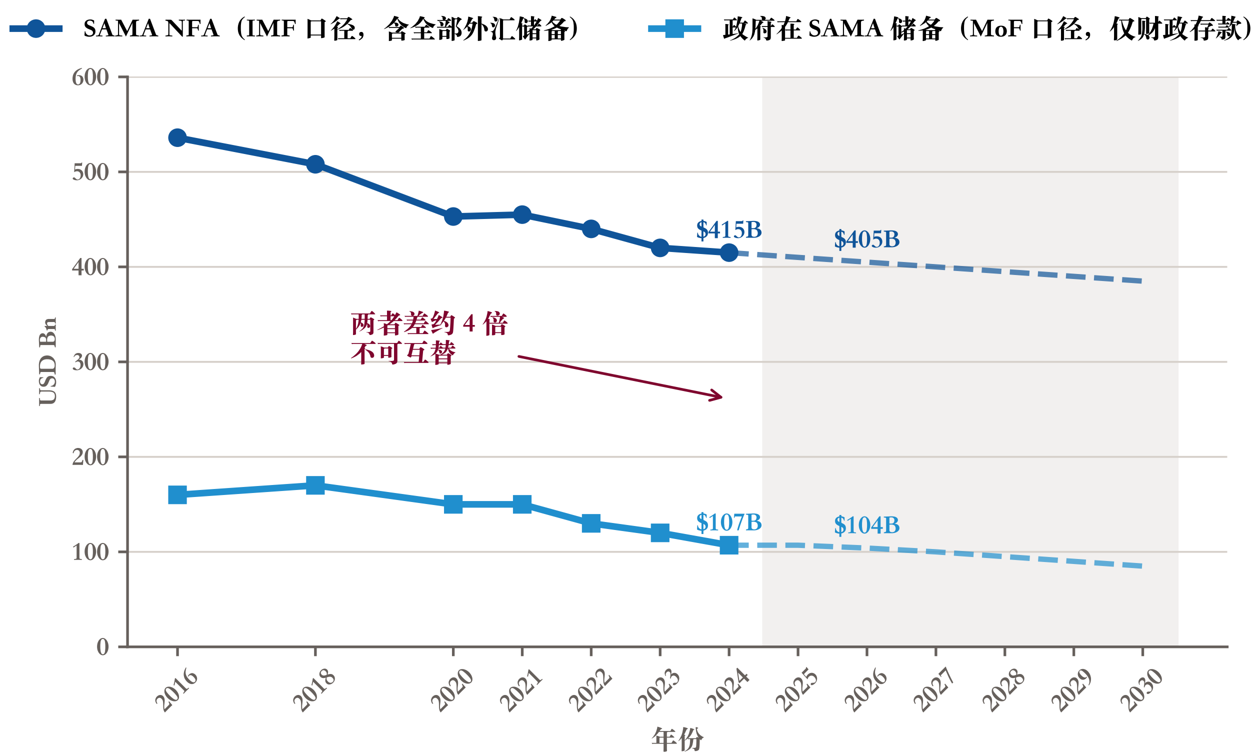
The three-scenario width is $320 billion (deficit spread 5x); the debt-level spread is 23 percentage points. Oil price is the single largest variable determining Vision 2030's fiscal reachability. The AI does not build its own forecasting model; it integrates three institutions' published forecasts. The specific oil-price path cannot be predicted; every forward-looking conclusion in this report uses a range.

4.4 Reserves dual caliper: $104B government deposits vs $415B SAMA NFA are not interchangeable

This is a caliper trap that the report must lay bare.

The IMF Article IV 2025 gives “Net Foreign Assets” at $415 billion (covering 187% of the IMF reserve adequacy metric and 15 months of imports at end-2024) (IMF 2025) — this is SAMA’s full foreign-exchange reserves, including PIF offshore assets, money base, and other foreign-exchange assets. MoF’s FY 2026 Budget gives the “government deposit at SAMA” at approximately SAR 390B at end-FY 2026 = $104 billion (Saudi Ministry of Finance 2025) — this is the government’s fiscal deposit at SAMA, immediately deployable to cover deficits without borrowing. The two differ 4x and are completely different concepts.

Figure 17: Dual-caliper reserves time series, 2016 to 2030E



Source: IMF Article IV 2025 (NFA $415B / 187

Going forward, this report makes the caliper explicit: when discussing “foreign exchange reserve adequacy,” cite the IMF $415B; when discussing “fiscal buffer” or “what the government can immediately deploy,” cite the MoF $104B. The two must never be substituted, or the reader will be misled. Bloomberg and other media occasionally conflate the two, treating $415B as “the Saudi government’s wallet.” That framing is particularly dangerous under a $50 oil scenario because it leads readers to underestimate fiscal pressure.

4.5 Reserve months 14.9 to 13.3 to 10.8, still well above the 3-month floor

Reserve months (foreign reserves / average monthly imports) is the IMF's standard reserve-adequacy metric.

Saudi reserve months: 14.9 (2024 annual), 14.1 (2025E), 13.3 (2026E) (IMF 2025) — annualised decline of about 0.8 months. (The IMF Article IV separately notes 15 months of imports for end-2024, the difference being annual average vs end-of-period.) Extrapolating this trajectory, the IMF baseline puts 2030 reserve months at approximately 12.1; this study, under a "stress scenario," extrapolates to 10.8 — still well above the IMF's 3-month suggested floor, structurally adequate.

But as the §3.3 downside scenario shows, the rate of reserves consumption could double. Under a $50 oil plus PIF-domestic-funding-acceleration combination, reserve months could fall from 14.9 to 8-10 within five years — still above the floor, but adequacy moves from "very ample" to "reasonable." The warning is about combination shocks, not single shocks.

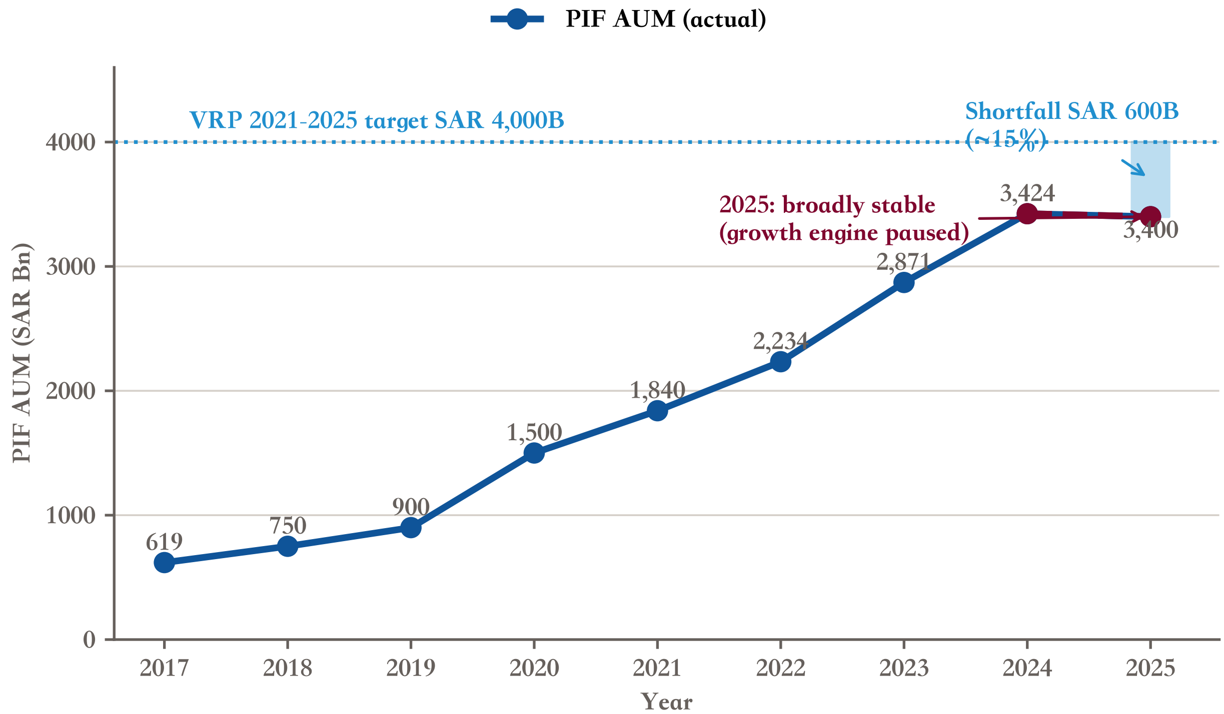
5 PIF and Giga-projects: the inflection point

PIF is the core investment vehicle for Vision 2030. Across four dimensions — AUM growth, funding sources, international share, Giga-projects execution rate — all are at turning points. PIF's own VRP 2021-2025 SAR 4 TN target will likely miss by more than SAR 600B; international share has moved from the 30% baseline to 24% (VRP 2021-2025) and media reporting points to further compression; NEOM, the flagship, has had its population target reduced by 80%. None of these is an accident; they are delayed reflections of earlier low execution rates. This section walks through PIF itself, NIS funding-source decomposition, Giga execution rate, and NEOM descope.

5.1 PIF AUM inflection point: SAR 600B+ short of the SAR 4 TN target

PIF's 2017-2024 AUM growth has been remarkable, from SAR 619B to SAR 3,424B ($913B), a CAGR of approximately 28% — among the fastest-growing sovereign wealth funds globally.

Figure 18: PIF AUM 2017 to 2025 + SAR 4 TN target gap

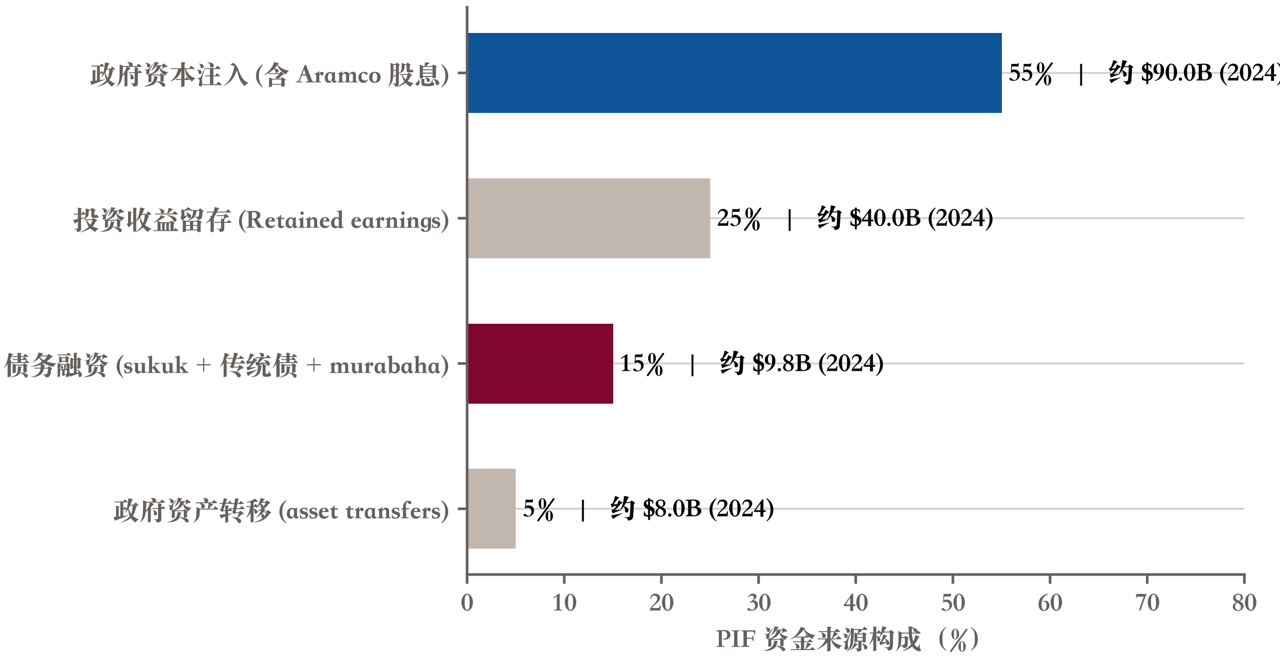


Source: PIF Annual Report 2024 (SAR 3,424B end-2024 / SAR 2,871B end-2023); PIF AR 2024 page 15 VRP 2021-2025 target AUM SAR 4 TN by end-2025; Vision 2030 AR 2025 p.21 confirms broadly stable at approximately $909B for 2025. Note: 2025 end estimated at approximately SAR 3,400B; the SAR 600B shortfall is the first signal of a material miss against PIF's own VRP 2025 target. Vision 2030 AR 2025 also publishes a new long-horizon 2030 PIF AUM target of approximately $2.67 trillion.

But 2025 is the inflection point. PIF's 2024 Annual Report, page 15, sets the VRP 2021-2025 target AUM at SAR 4 TN by 2025 (PIF 2025). End-2024 actual was SAR 3.42 TN, leaving a SAR 580B gap; this study extrapolates 2025 AUM as broadly flat around SAR 3.4 TN (PIF 2024 AR does not provide a 2025 actual). Gap to the SAR 4 TN target: SAR 600B+, equivalent to a 15% shortfall — a material miss against PIF's own first-round VRP target. Vision 2030 AR 2025 (page 21) confirms approximately $909B for 2025 (broadly stable YoY) and publishes a new 2030 target of $2.67 trillion (≈ SAR 10 trillion), maintaining the long-horizon ambition even as the 2025 milestone slips.

The reasons for the turn are three. Oil price decline has shrunk PIF's injection source (Aramco dividends + government transfers). Vision 2030 domestic projects have consumed funds faster than expected, requiring PIF to inject more into NEOM and Giga. Global high-valuation regimes plus rate hikes have limited valuation accretion on new international investments.

Figure 19: PIF 2024 funding-source breakdown



Source: PIF Annual Report 2024; KPMG audited Consolidated FS 2024. Note: percentages are this study's estimates (PIF does not publicly provide exact proportions); $9.8B debt issuance is the FY 2024 actual (per PIF AR 2024), including the first GBP asset-liability matching + the first murabaha.

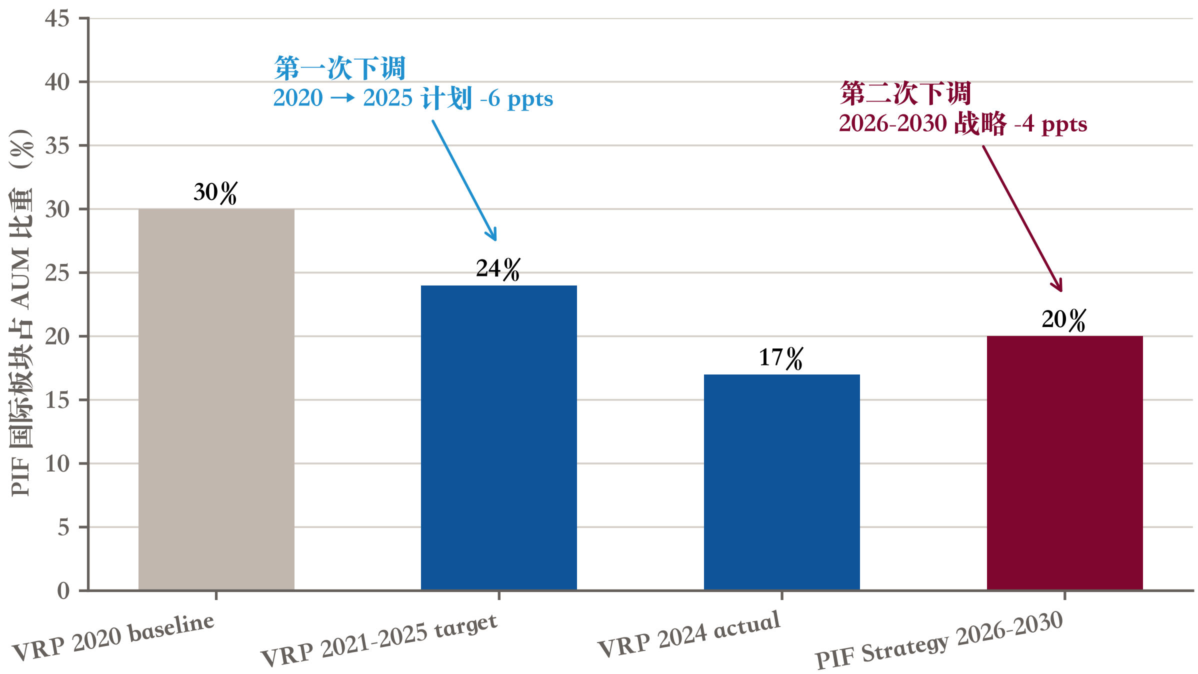
To sustain growth, PIF has entered the phase of "growth on leverage." 2024 saw a single-year debt issuance of $9.8 billion — unprecedented in scale, including the first GBP ALM ($828M), $3.5B sukuk, $5.5B conventional, a $15B revolving credit facility, and the first murabaha credit facility ($7B). Moody's upgraded PIF's long-term issuer rating to Aa3 (from A1) — rating agencies remain confident in PIF, but the pace of issuance itself signals that PIF can no longer rely solely on government injections to sustain expansion.

5.2 PIF international share, two-stage decline: 30% (baseline) → 24% (VRP) → reported further compression

PIF's strategic pivot has supporting data.

PIF's 2024 Annual Report page 15 makes clear that under VRP 2021-2025, the international segment as a share of AUM was to be reduced from the 2020 baseline of 30% to 24% — and as of 2024, actual stood at only 17%, below even the 24% target (PIF 2025). The downward pace exceeds expectations. In April 2026, the PIF Board adopted its 2026-2030 strategy; the official PIF press release gives only directional language (six-priority ecosystem focus, strengthened domestic investment) and does not explicitly publish a new international-share target. According to media reporting, the new strategy may further compress international share to approximately 20% (domestic to approximately 80%); the specific figure has no PIF official written caliper at time of writing. Even setting aside the unconfirmed 20% number, the trajectory of 30% → 24% → 17% actual is sufficient evidence that domestic-funding demand has moved from "planned slowdown" to "confirmed acceleration."

Figure 20: PIF international share, two-stage downward revision



Source: PIF Annual Report 2024 page 15 (VRP 2021-2025 international share 24

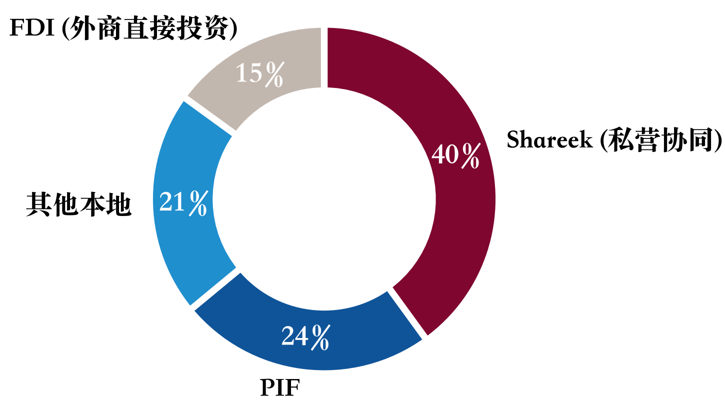
This pivot has direct implications for global capital markets. PIF is the largest shareholder in Lucid Motors, the acquirer of Newcastle United, a major shareholder in Magic Leap, LIV Golf, Heathrow Airport (15% in 2024), Selfridges Group, and Aman Group. The international-share decline (baseline 30% → actual 17% → media-reported further compression) implies that PIF will not, over the next five years, significantly add to its overseas allocation. It will continue to hold existing positions, but incremental capital will mostly flow back domestically.

5.3 The truth about NIS $3.3T: government controls only 45%

The public narrative that "the Saudi government is investing $3.3T to drive Vision 2030" is common — and the narrative needs to be corrected.

Goldman Sachs' 2023 report, pages 6-7, makes explicit the funding-source decomposition of NIS (National Investment Strategy 2021) at $3.3 TN (SAR 12.4 TN) (AlAzmeh et al. 2023). Shareek (private-sector partnership) accounts for 40% (SAR 5T), PIF accounts for 24% (SAR 3T), other domestic 21% (SAR 2.6T), FDI 15% (SAR 1.8T). The portion directly controlled by the government is PIF's 24% plus the discretionary share of "other domestic" — combining these conservatively yields approximately 45% (i.e., PIF 24% plus the government-influenceable portion of the 21% "other domestic"), under half, approximately $1.5T.

Figure 21: NIS $3.3T funding-source pie

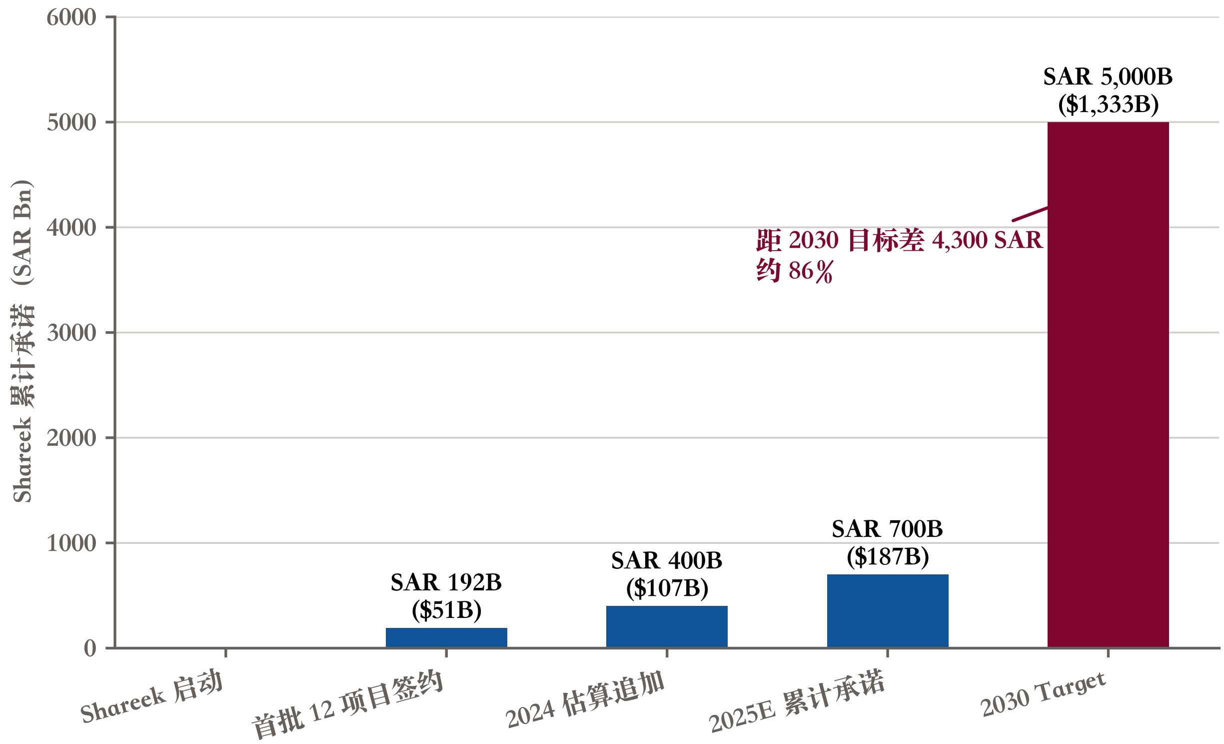


Source: Goldman Sachs Capex Super-Cycle 2023 page 6-7. Note: Shareek (Private Sector Partnership Reinforcement Center) launched 2021, targeting SAR 5T of private investment by 2030; PIF 24

The remaining 55% is "condition-dependent." Shareek is fundamentally a government-channelled private-sector commitment, the actual fulfilment of which depends on private-sector decisions. FDI at 15% is heavily exposed to global capital flows, oil prices, and geopolitics. The "government investing $3.3T" narrative is inaccurate; the precise statement is "a government-channelled $3.3T investment programme."

Shareek's actual execution can be checked. GS page 9 gives the first wave (March 2023) of 12 project signings totalling SAR 192B ($51.2B) across 8 private-sector companies, expected to contribute SAR 466B ($124B) to Saudi GDP and create 64,000 jobs. Subsequent 2024-2025 cumulative commitments are estimated at approximately SAR 700B, leaving 86% of the SAR 5T 2030 target outstanding — meaning the remaining 5 years would need to deliver 7x the cumulative pace. Given Shareek's commitments are highly sensitive to oil price and macro expectations, this is challenging.

Figure 22: Shareek cumulative commitments progress



Source: Goldman Sachs Capex Super-Cycle 2023 page 9 (first 12 projects SAR 192B = $51.2B). Note: 2024-2025 cumulative commitments are this study's estimate; Shareek launched 2021, targeting SAR 5T of private investment by 2030 (approximately 40

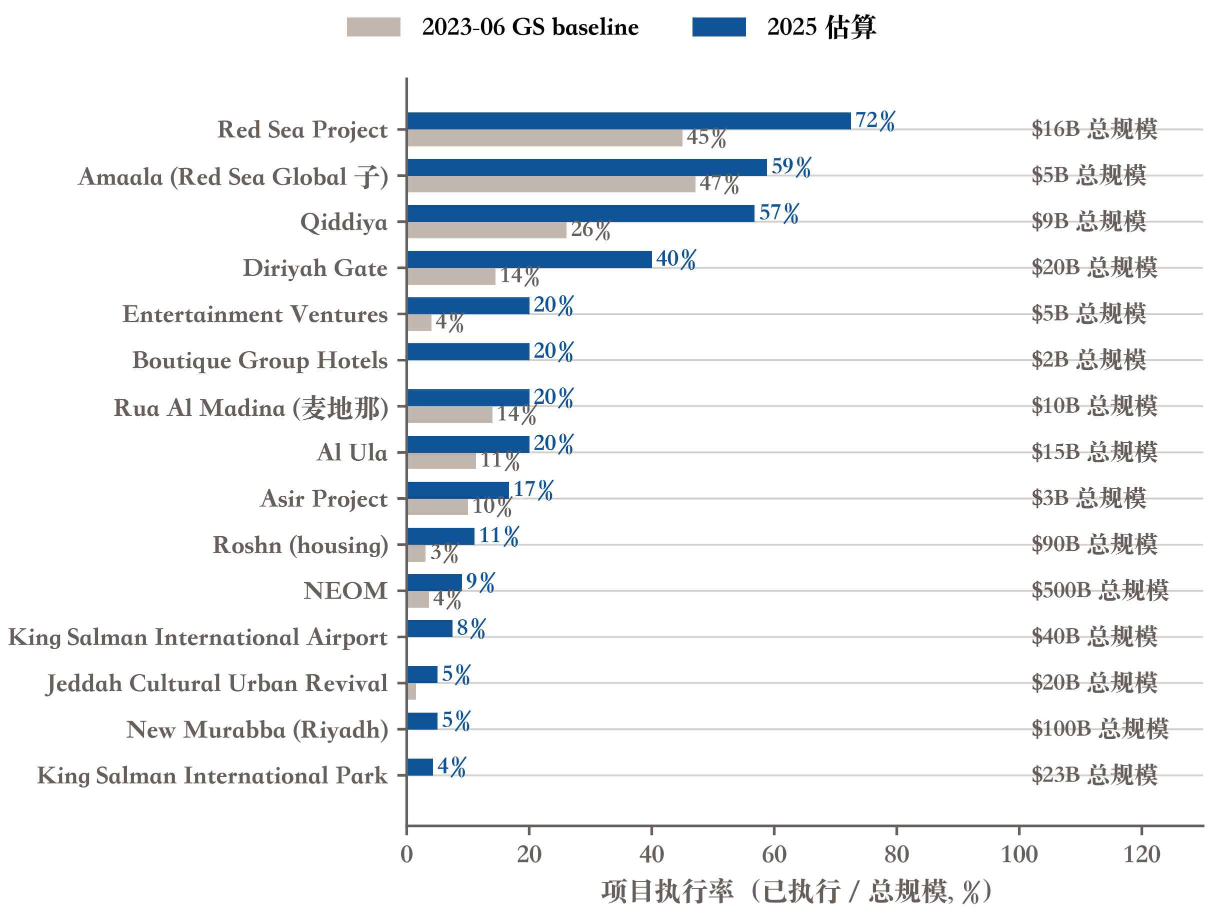
5.4 Giga-projects execution rate, dual-source comparison: GS 6% vs MEED cross-caliper

The Giga-projects are the most narrative-heavy element of Vision 2030. Actual execution is far behind public perception, but the two core data sources use different calipers, and the report must state them separately to avoid pulling them onto the same denominator.

The first source is Goldman Sachs' September 2023 report, page 7, Exhibit 8 (AlAzmeh et al. 2023): 14 Giga-projects with a total project cost of $879 billion; as of June 2023, $50 billion executed; on the "executed / total project cost" caliper, overall execution rate is 6%. Detail: NEOM total $500B, executed $18.2B (4%); Red Sea Project $16B / $7.2B (45%, the most advanced); Qiddiya $8.8B / $2.3B (26%); Diriyah Gate $20B / $2.9B (15%); Roshn (housing) $90B / $2.8B (3%); New Murabba and King Salman Airport at 0% at the report's time of writing.

The second source is MEED's 2025 tracking (MEED 2025): Giga-projects' cumulative awarded contracts at $116.6 billion; total contract value at $196 billion. Two new denominators here, "awarded" and "contract value," are not the same caliper as GS's "executed" and "total project cost." $116.6B / $879B yields approximately 13%; $116.6B / $196B yields approximately 60%. The two figures mean entirely different things and cannot be collapsed into "overall execution rate." This study preserves GS's original 14-project baseline alongside MEED's 2025 awarded values in fig_4_6 for side-by-side reading; the denominators are not forcibly unified.

Figure 23: 14 Giga-projects, GS 2023 (executed / total) vs MEED 2025 (awarded), dual source



Source: Goldman Sachs Capex Super-Cycle 2023 page 7 Exhibit 8 (2023-06 baseline); MEED 2025 (2025 awarded $116.6B, NEOM approximately $45B, Red Sea Global approximately $11.6B). Note: 2025 project-level execution rate is this study's estimate, based on MEED data + NEOM descope narrative.

Extrapolating to 2030 overall completion under this pace, the optimistic scenario is about 30% — far from the public perception of "comprehensive build-out." Red Sea Global and Amaala are the most advanced (2025 execution rate 70%+), with a chance of completion in 2027-2028, but NEOM is highly likely to be materially descoped.

5.5 NEOM descope: from a $500B ambition to an 80% population cut in 4 years

NEOM is the Vision 2030 flagship, and its descope trajectory is the most-tracked narrative shift of the past four years.

Full timeline: October 2017, NEOM project announced with a planned total investment of $500 billion. July 2021, The Line publicly disclosed, targeting 1.5M people by 2030, 9M by 2050. September 2023, GS reports NEOM at 4% executed. April 2024, Bloomberg first reports The Line being substantially scaled back. September 2025, The Line construction paused (only 2.4 km of foundation completed). October 2025, Saudi Arabia presents its "Less NEOM, More AI" Wall Street pitch (Bloomberg 2025a). December 2025, Saudi Finance Minister publicly acknowledges that Vision 2030 projects can be cancelled (Bloomberg 2025b). Q1 2026 (January-March), multiple media outlets (Euronews, Middle East Insider, others) continuously report The Line's 2030 population target reduced from 1.5M to <300K, equivalent to an 80% cut (the Saudi government has not officially confirmed this specific figure). April 15, 2026, the PIF Board adopts its 2026-2030 strategy; the press release publicly states the 80% domestic / 20% international targets (the PIF official website is Cloudflare-blocked and was not directly accessible to this study; the citation draws on SPA, The National, and Arab News as multi-source equivalent-to-primary).

Figure 24: NEOM / The Line descope timeline

原计划 / 启动　**首次警示 / scaled-back**　**公开承认 / 暂停 / 实质降标**

2026-04	**PIF Board 通过 2026-2030 战略：国际 30%→20%；6 大生态聚焦**
2026-03	**The Line 人口目标从 1.5M 砍至 <300K（-80%）**
2026-01	**与亚洲奥委会谈延后 2029 NEOM 冬奥**
2025-12	**沙特财长公开承认可砍 Vision 2030 项目**
2025-10	**沙特 Wall Street 路演：「Less NEOM More AI」**
2025-09	**The Line 施工暂停；仅完成 2.4 km 地基**
2024-04	**Bloomberg 首次报道：The Line 大幅 scaled-back**
2023-09	**GS 报告披露：NEOM $500B 总规模仅执行 $18.2B (4%)**
2022-07	**NEOM Concept 完整发布；Trojena 山地度假区 + Sindalah 岛**
2021-07	**The Line 公开披露：170 km 线性城；目标人口 2030 年 1.5M、2050 年 9M**
2017-10	**NEOM 项目宣布；规划总投资 $500B**

Source: 2024-2026 timeline events partly drawn from media coverage (not all entered into bibliography) - Bloomberg / Financial Times / Fast Company / Gulf International Forum. Note: severity grading: 0 = project launch; 1 = first warning (GS report etc.); 2 = scaled-back (from 2024-04); 3 = public acknowledgement / construction paused (2025-09/10/12); 4 = material descope (2026-Q1 The Line 80

NEOM is not a failure, but it has been cut by 80%. What the Saudi government is doing is a "soft landing": preserve the NEOM brand, while substantively downgrading it from "the future linear city" to "a regional AI / data centre + energy-transition test bed." The descope's impact on overall Vision 2030 reachability is material — the originally-planned NEOM single-project contribution to non-oil GDP, employment, and foreign investment will all fall well short of 2030 expectations. Gulf International Forum's 2025 analysis calls this adjustment "Rebalancing Ambition" — lowering expectations without abandoning the path.

6 Social reform has outrun economic diversification

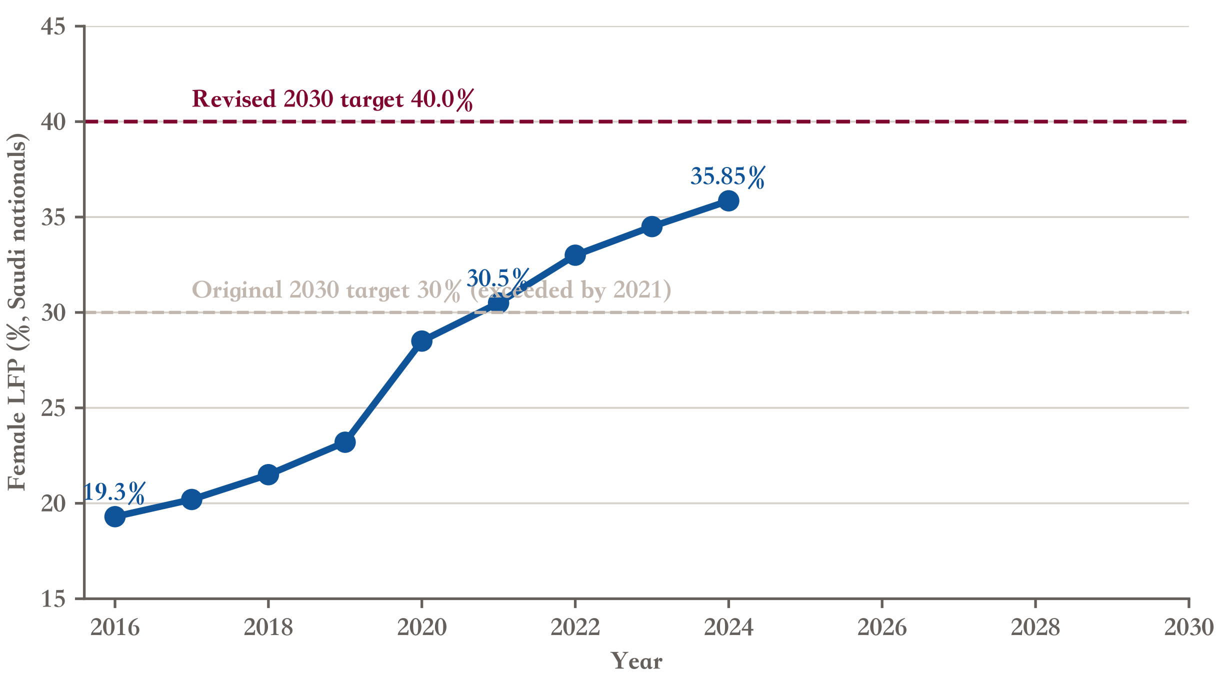
Splitting Vision 2030's three pillars (A Vibrant Society / A Thriving Economy / An Ambitious Nation), social reform (Vibrant Society) progress has clearly outrun economic diversification (Thriving Economy). Several social indicators have already met 2030 targets ahead of schedule: female LFP at 35.85% has overtaken the original 30% target; the homeownership rate at 66.24% is close to the 70% target; tourism visitors at 115.9M exceed the 100M interim target; Umrah pilgrims from outside the Kingdom at 18M exceed the 15M interim target; IMD competitiveness at 17th (well ahead of the original 39th target); banking sector total assets and fintech count have exceeded the 2025 interim targets. Social reform has outrun for a structural reason: low political resistance + strong government execution + relative decoupling from the oil economy.

6.1 The female employment revolution: LFP doubled, +84% private-sector female employment in four years

Female labour force participation (LFP) is the most uncontestable Vision 2030 achievement.

2016: 19.3%; 2021: 30% (the original Vision 2030 target); 2024: 35.85% (IMF 2025). Eight years to double from 19.3% to 35.85%. Vision 2030 raised the 2030 target to 40% after the original target was met — this is a positive example of "moving the goalposts," because the original target was too conservative.

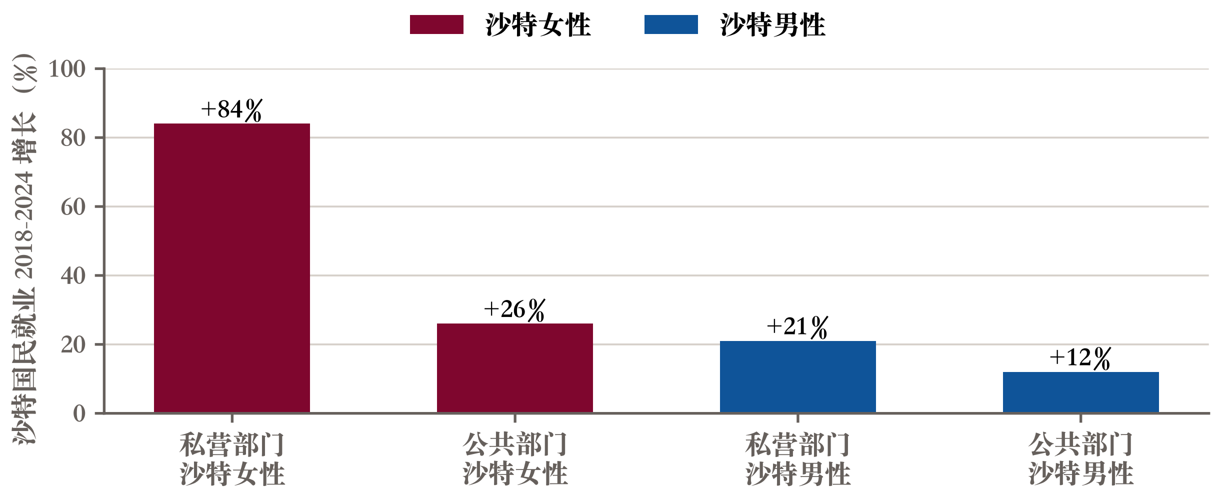
Figure 25: Female LFP 2016 to 2024 + dual target



Source: Vision 2030 Executive Summary 2016 (baseline 19.3

The IMF Working Paper of January 2026 gives finer detail (Koll et al. 2026). Between 2018 and 2024, decomposed by sector and gender: private-sector Saudi women employment +84%, private-sector Saudi men +21%, public-sector Saudi women +26%, public-sector Saudi men +12%. (The +84% figure is derived from Figure 18 underlying values; the WP's prose states only the aggregate that "since 2020, nearly 700,000 Saudis have joined the private sector workforce.") The private × female combination at +84% is a rare data point in transitioning economies.

Figure 26: Saudi national employment by sector and gender



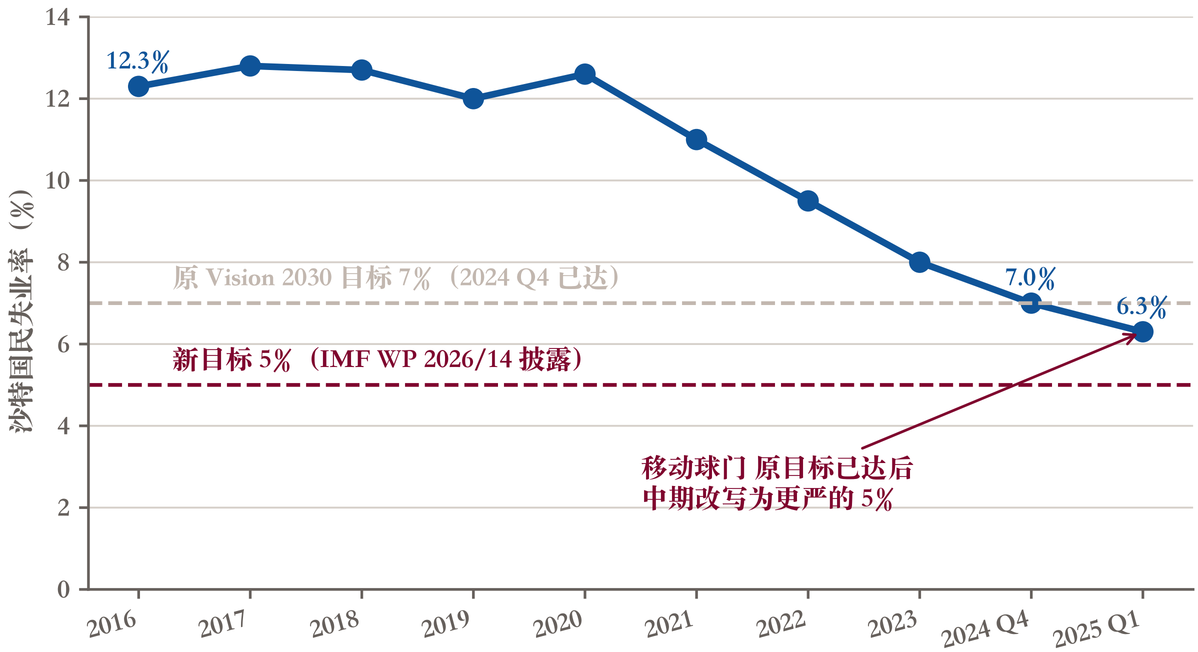
Source: IMF Working Paper 2026/14 (Koll, Medici, Tavares & Saito) Figure 18 "Public and Private Sector Employment by Gender." Note: Saudi nationals only; private-sector growth includes both Saudization quota policy and new jobs in tourism / entertainment.

The drivers include the 2018 legalisation of women driving, the 2019 enabling of independent passports and travel, the 2021 extension of Saudization quotas to women, large-scale female-positions opening in tourism (airports, hotels, retail), and new jobs in the entertainment industry (concerts, e-sports, sports). This is policy-driven real reform, not statistical artifact.

6.2 Unemployment 7% → 6.3%: original target met, new target 5%

Saudi-national unemployment (excluding expatriate workers) fell from 12.3% in 2016 to 7.0% in Q4 2024, meeting the original Vision 2030 target (Koll et al. 2026), and to 6.3% in Q1 2025 (IMF WP quarterly point; the Vision 2030 Annual Report's full-year 2025 reading is 7.2% (Saudi Vision 2030 2026), the two sources differ in caliper — quarterly points are more sensitive to short-term variation).

Figure 27: Saudi-national unemployment + original 7% / new 5% target



Source: IMF Article IV historical / IMF Working Paper 2026/14 page 7 (Saudi-national unemployment Q4/2024 = 7

The IMF Working Paper page 7 explicitly states that the original Vision 2030 target of 7% has been changed to 5%. This is a concrete instance of "moving the goalposts": the target is raised after being met, so the "achievement" narrative remains permanent. Carnegie's "limited accountability" claim is supported in writing here (Carnegie Endowment for International Peace 2025).

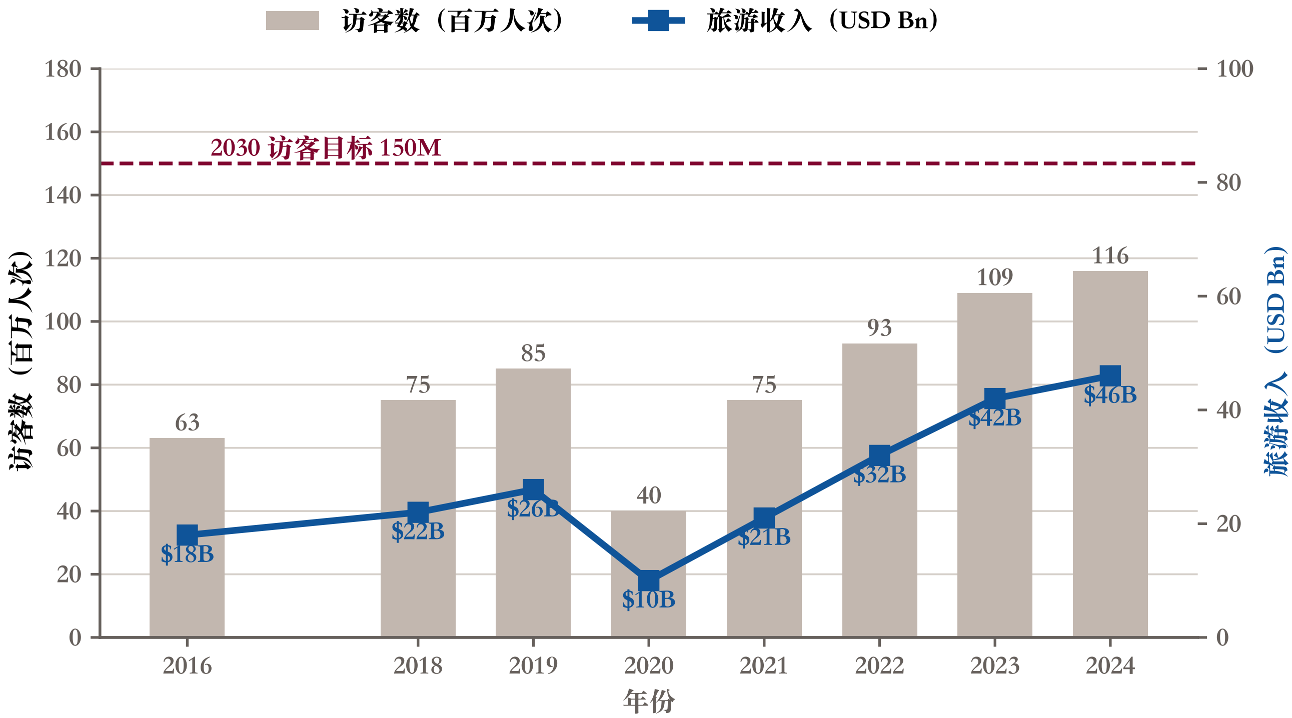
But unemployment improvement itself is structural, not a statistical adjustment. Youth (15-24) unemployment fell from 28% in 2020 to 14% in 2024; female unemployment was halved from 32.4% in 2020 to 13.1% in 2024, falling further to 11.9% in Q4 2024 (Koll et al. 2026). These are real structural improvements within four years.

6.3 Tourism and pilgrimage: four KPIs already past 2030 targets, but volume up more than price

Tourism is one of Vision 2030's best-performing segments.

Tourist visitors rose from 63.1M in 2016 to 115.9M in 2024 (IMF 2025), exceeding the 100M 2025 interim target — leaving a 23% gap to the 150M 2030 target (with 5 years left). Umrah pilgrims from outside the Kingdom rose from 6.2M to 18.03M (Saudi Vision 2030 2026), exceeding the 15M interim target.

Figure 28: Tourism visitors vs tourism revenue, dual axis



Source: UNWTO / Vision 2030 Annual Report 2025 / IMF Article IV 2025. Note: visitors 2024 = 115.9M (Vision 2030 KPI already exceeds the 100M interim target); revenue 2024 approximately $46B estimate (Saudi official + industry research); the Vision 2030 framework targets 10

But volume and price are not moving in step. Visitors grew 1.8x over eight years; tourism revenue grew only 2.6x; visitor average spend rose modestly. The reason is that most visitors come from religious tourism (Umrah / Hajj, lower per-capita spend) plus short-haul GCC neighbours (medium per-capita spend). Under the Vision 2030 framework, the 2030 target for tourism's GDP contribution is 10%, and an investment-catalyst target of approximately $80B has been set ((Saudi Vision 2030 2026), note this is an investment-catalyst target, not a revenue target). On total spending, 2025 Saudi tourism total spend already reached approximately SAR 300B / $81B (close in magnitude, but spending and revenue are different calipers). To lift the revenue side rather than only visitor numbers, Saudi Arabia needs breakthroughs in premium tourism, entertainment events, and luxury retail.

The table below summarises six KPIs that are already at or near 2030 targets.

Table 1: Six KPIs at or above interim targets

KPI	2016 baseline	2024-2025 actual	2030 target	Status
Saudi-national unemployment	12.3%	6.3%	7% (original)	Exceeded
Umrah pilgrims from outside Kingdom	6.2M	18M	15M	Exceeded
Female LFP	19.3%	35.85%	40% (revised)	89% achieved
Homeownership rate	47%	66.24%	70%	95% achieved
Tourism visitors	63.1M	115.9M	150M	77% on track
IMD competitiveness ranking	39th	17th	15th	Past 2025 interim

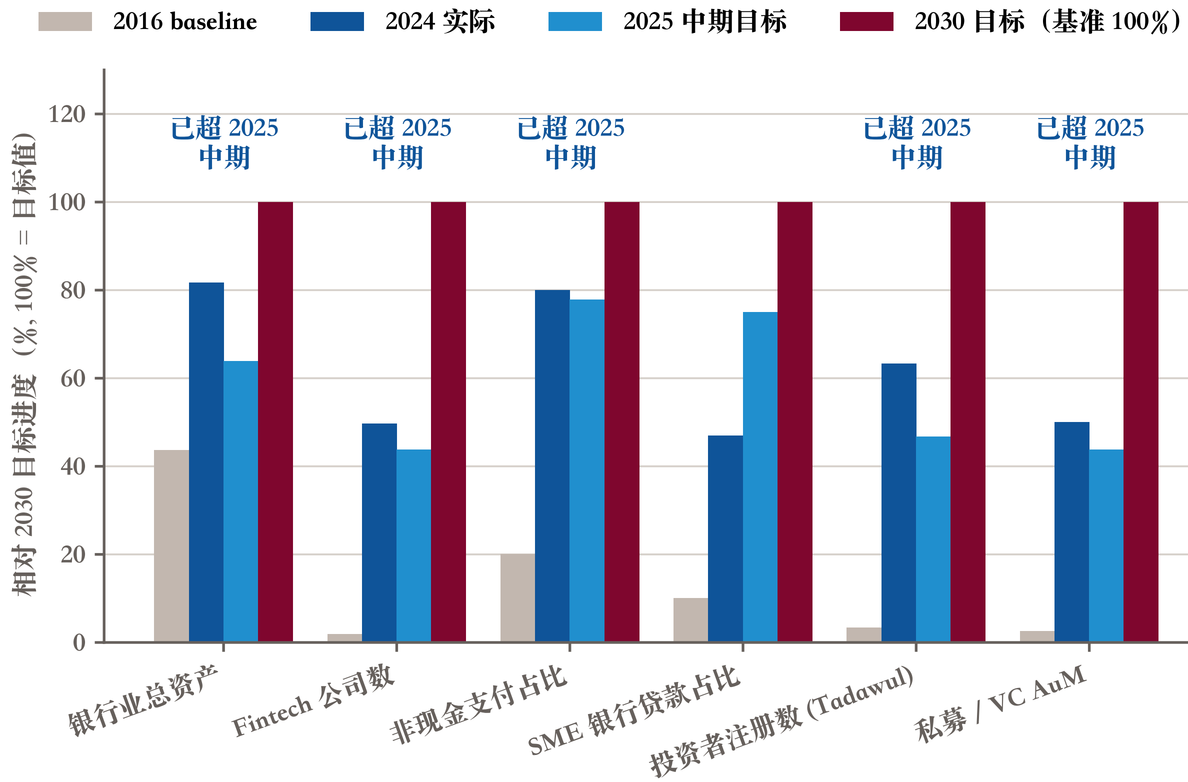
Source: Vision 2030 Annual Report 2025 + IMF Article IV 2025 + GASTAT National Accounts 2024. Note: "actual" column shows the latest publicly available 2024-2025 reading; female LFP and IMD have exceeded their original 2030 targets but the official subsequently raised the targets (see main text on "moving the goalposts").

6.4 Financial sector: FSDP multiple targets past 2025 interim, Islamic 75% one of the highest globally

The Financial Sector Development Programme (FSDP) is Vision 2030's most stable execution segment.

Banking sector total assets at end-2024 stood at SAR 4,494B, exceeding the 2025 interim target of SAR 3,515B (SAMA 2024a). Fintech firms at 261, exceeding the 2025 interim target of 230 (SAMA 2024b). Bank CAR at 20.1% (2023), in the global high range (SAMA 2024b). SME bank loans as a share of total loans at 11.3% in 2025 — exceeding the 11% 2025 interim target (Saudi Vision 2030 2026), up from 2.0% in 2016 (5.6x growth), but still 8.7 ppts short of the 2030 target of 20% (see §2).

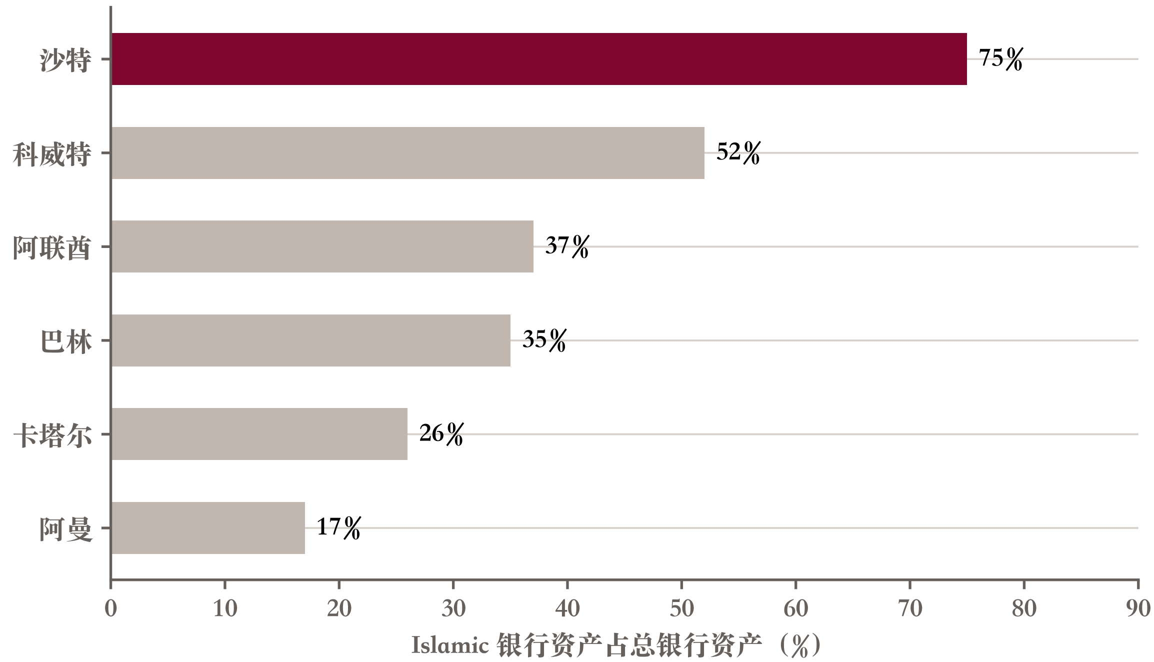
Figure 29: FSDP six core indicators progress



Source: SAMA FSDP Annual Report 2024 / SAMA FSR 2024 / Vision 2030 / IMF Art IV 2025 / CMA. Note: non-cash payments numbers differ slightly by caliper / year (SAMA FSDP 2024 vs FSR 2024); all indicators are normalised to "percentage of 2030 target" for comparison; actual units differ (see data.md).

More notable is the differentiated path of Saudi financial modernisation. The IMF FSAP 2024 report (CR 24/281) is explicit that Saudi banks' Islamic-product assets account for more than 75% of total assets — one of the largest in the world (IMF 2024). Saudi Vision 2030 financial modernisation is "modernisation inside the Islamic framework," a path completely different from traditional financial centres (London, Singapore).

Figure 30: GCC Islamic banking asset share



Source: GCC cross-comparison data; IFSB original report not in bibliography - IMF FSAP Saudi Arabia 2024 (CR 24/281); Islamic Financial Services Board (IFSB) Stability Report. Note: Islamic banking assets as a share of total banking assets; excludes Islamic insurance (Takaful) and capital markets; Saudi Vision 2030 financial modernisation is "modernisation inside the Islamic framework," distinct from traditional financial-centre paths.

Differentiation is both a strength and a constraint. The strength: Saudi Arabia can serve global Islamic-finance demand (GCC neighbours, Central Asia, Southeast Asia, North Africa Muslim countries), packaging fintech / capital markets / insurance / wealth management with Islamic products. The constraint: Saudi banks have difficulty directly entering non-Islamic mainstream markets (Europe, North America, East Asia); the "financial hub" is more likely to be the GCC + global Islamic capital nexus rather than a direct competitor to London or Singapore.

The IMF FSAP also flagged latent risks in the Saudi financial system: large construction and infrastructure exposures (PIF and NEOM risk transmission to the banking system), elevated funding concentration, data gaps impeding systemic-risk monitoring (IMF 2024). These risks would be amplified in the 2026-2030 oil-price downside scenario.

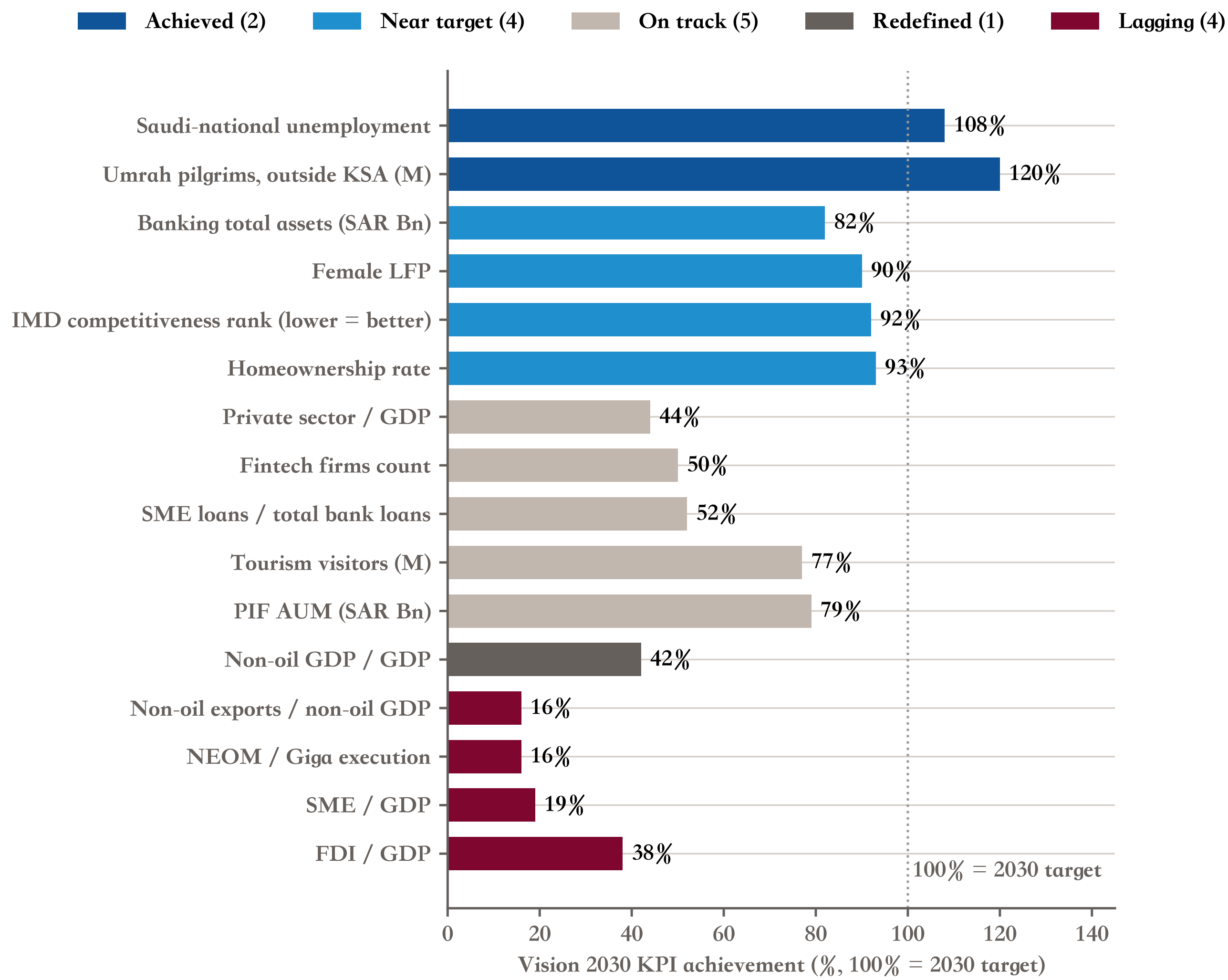
7 Five years of reachability

This study uses the IMF, GS, JPM, and Saudi official as the four published-forecast inputs to build the scenario framework. The §6.2 three-scenario KPI completion rates and cumulative deficit figures are this study's scenario estimates, not direct external-forecast synthesis. The conclusion remains "half done, half deferred." Based on synthesised published forecasts, 2030 Saudi KPI completion will land at approximately 70% (including 85%+ "near") / 50% (strict ≥100%). This range is determined by three exogenous variables: oil price, reform pace, geopolitical shocks. This section first produces the 16-core-KPI four-quadrant classification, then the three-scenario KPI-completion analysis, then the three exogenous-variable transmission discussion, then directional asset-class implications.

7.1 16 core KPIs, four-quadrant status

From the original 96 Vision 2030 KPIs, this study selects 16 of the most representative and independently verifiable indicators, classifying them across four status bands: substantively achieved (≥100%), on track (30%-100% progress), redefined (target raised at interim or methodology recomposed), lagging (<30% or substantively de-scoped).

Figure 31: 16 KPIs, four-quadrant status



Source: Vision 2030 Annual Report 2025 / IMF Article IV 2025 / IMF WP 2026/14 / GASTAT NA 2024 / SAMA / GS / MEED synthesis.
Note: status classification: achieved ≥100

The full scorecard appears below. Distribution by 5 bands: achieved 2 (Saudi-national unemployment, Umrah pilgrims), near 4 (female LFP, homeownership, banking assets, IMD competitiveness), on track 5 (tourism visitors, PIF AUM, fintech, private sector GDP contribution, SME loans), redefined 1 (non-oil GDP share, due to GDP rebasing), lagging 4 (non-oil exports, SME GDP share, NEOM/Giga, FDI).

Table 2: 16 core KPIs, full scorecard

KPI	2016 baseline	2024-2025 actual	2030 target	Achievement	Status
Female LFP (%)	19.3	35.85	40	89%	Near
Saudi-national unemployment (%)	12.3	6.3	7 (original)	108%	Achieved
Homeownership rate (%)	47	66.24	70	95%	Near
Tourism visitors (M)	63.1	115.9	150	77%	On track
Umrah pilgrims (M, outside KSA)	6.2	18.0	15	120%	Achieved
Banking sector total assets (SAR Bn)	2,400	4,494	5,500	82%	Near
Fintech firms count	10	261	525	50%	On track
IMD competitiveness ranking	39th	17th	15th	92%	Near
Non-oil GDP / GDP (%)	50	55	65	42%	Redefined*
Non-oil exports / non-oil GDP (%)	16.9	22.14	50	16%	Lagging
SME share of GDP (%)	20	22.9	35	19%	Lagging

KPI	2016 baseline	2024-2025 actual	2030 target	Achievement	Status
SME loans / bank loans (%)	2.0	11.3	20	52%	On track
Private sector contribution to GDP (%)	40	51	65	44%	On track
FDI / GDP (%)	1.0	2.8	5.7	38%	Lagging
Giga-projects execution (%)	0	13	80	16%	Lagging
PIF AUM (SAR Bn)	1,500	3,424	4,000	79%	On track

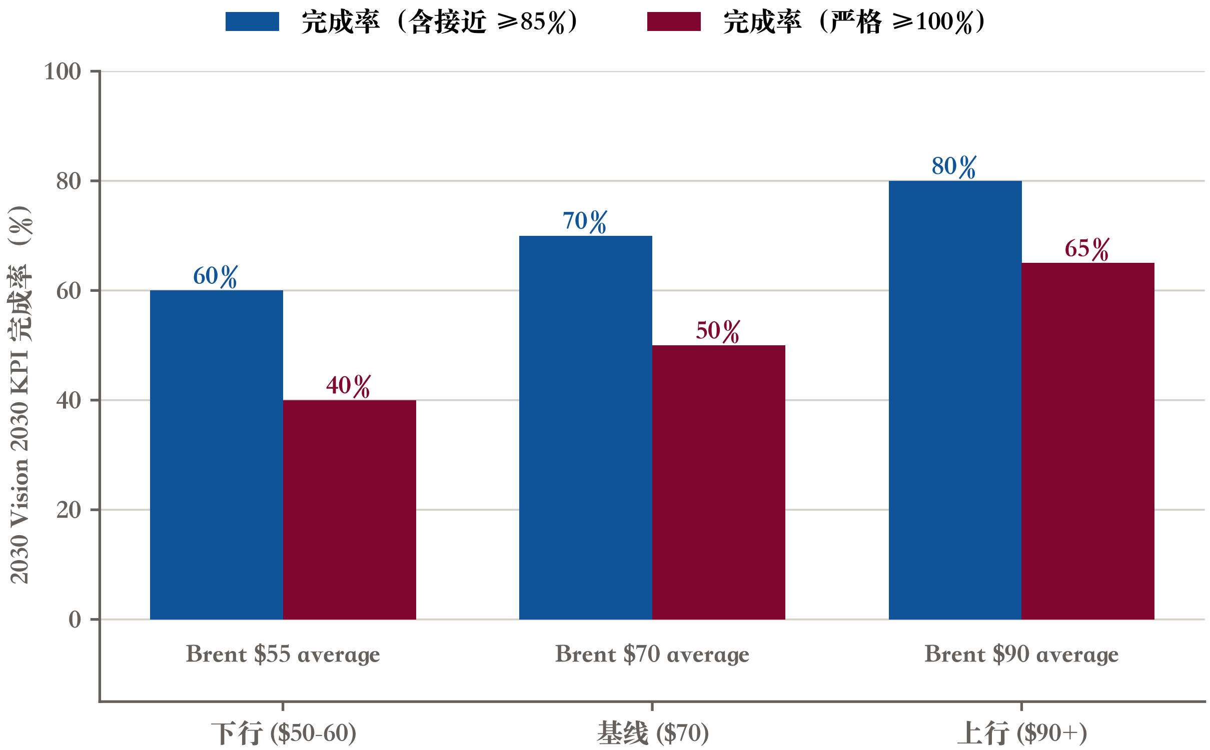
Source: Vision 2030 Annual Report 2025 + IMF Article IV 2025 + IMF WP 2026/14 + GS Capex Tracker 2023 + MEED 2025. Note: status classification (achieved / near / on track / redefined / lagging) is this study's composite judgement, per the §6.1 five-band definitions. Updated 2025 readings for FDI (2.8

* "Redefined" indicates that the GASTAT May 2025 rebasing lifted the official caliper (IMF same-methodology 72% → 76%; but cross-source 5 data points span 30.7 ppts, see §1.1). The "share of GDP" indicator means different things under different calipers; target interpretation is disputed.

7.2 Three oil-price scenarios for 2030 KPI completion: base 70% / upside 80% / downside 60%

Treating oil price as the single largest variable, three scenarios can be constructed.

Figure 32: Three oil-price scenarios for KPI completion



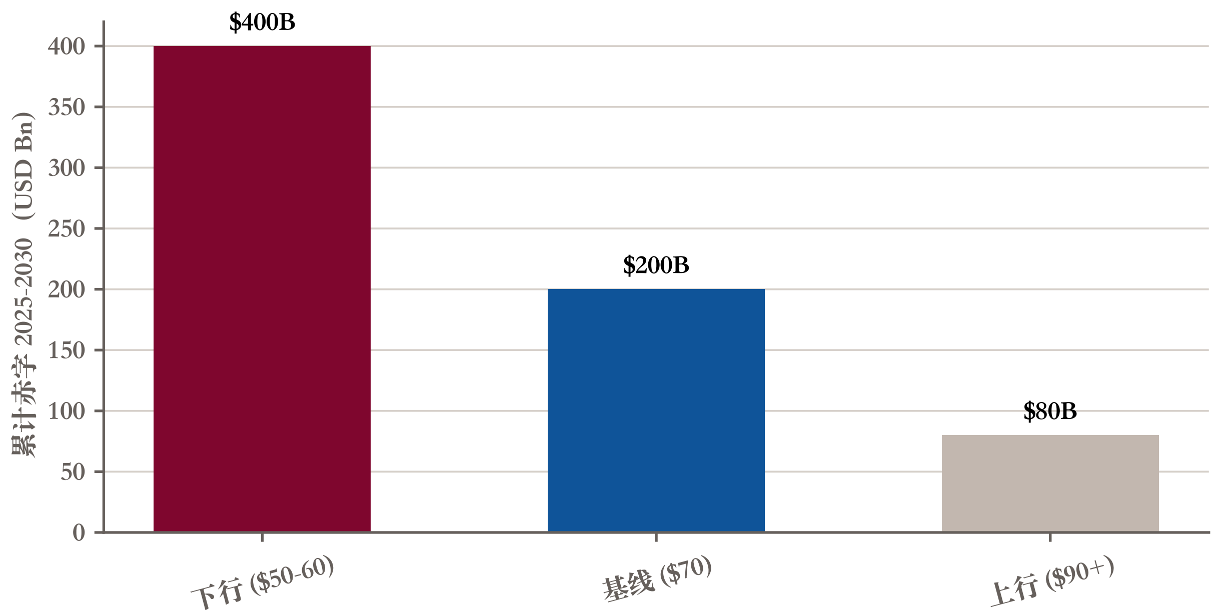
Source: IMF Art IV 2025 baseline + Annex VII Lower Oil Price + GS upside. Note: completion rates are this study's composite judgement based on the three institutions' published forecasts (the AI does not build its own forecast model); the "strict" caliper excludes "near (85-99

Base scenario (Brent average $70): overall KPI completion 70% (including near) / 50% (strict); 2025-2030 cumulative fiscal deficit $200B, 2030 public debt 38% of GDP (see §3); reserve months 11-12; NEOM and Giga completion approximately 35%; non-oil export share 30%-35%; female LFP, unemployment, tourism, finance four areas preserve their advantage.

Upside (Brent average $90+): KPI completion 80% / 65%; fiscal headroom ample, Giga projects can accelerate; 2030 public debt 32% of GDP; non-oil export share could rise to 35%-40%; Vision 2030 overall close to the original narrative.

Downside (Brent average $55): KPI completion 60% / 40%; significant fiscal-tightening pressure, the IMF-recommended 3.3% of non-oil GDP consolidation could accelerate to 5%+; public debt could rise to 55% of GDP; NEOM and Giga descope further; non-oil growth falls back to 2.5%-3%; reserve months fall to 8-10.

Figure 33: Three scenarios for 2025-2030 cumulative deficit



Source: IMF Article IV 2025 Annex VII / Annex VIII; GS Saudi deficit warning 2025-04. Note: downside cumulative deficit jumps to approximately $400B; public debt path see fig_6_4; reserves path see §3.5 / §3.6.

The three-scenario width is 20 percentage points (KPI completion range). Even in the downside, Vision 2030 still completes 40%+ of strict KPIs — meaning this study's opening "half done" judgement holds in any scenario. To what degree the remaining 60% gets done is determined by oil price.

7.3 Three exogenous-variable transmissions: oil price / reform pace / geopolitical shock

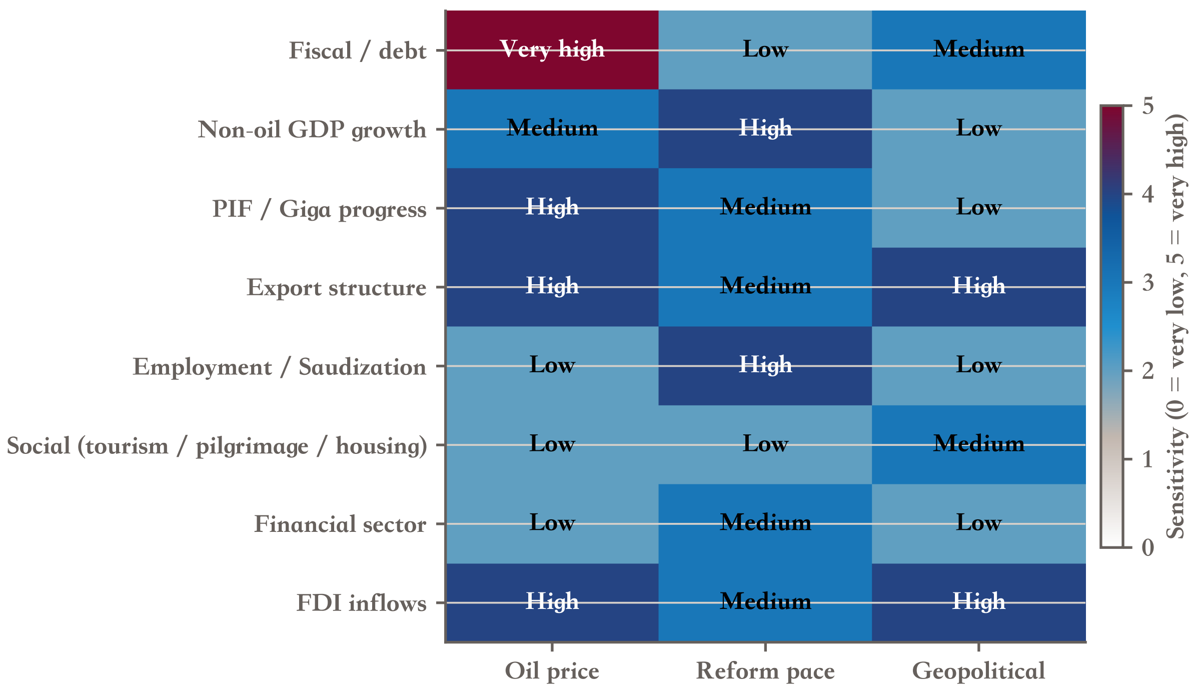
The exogenous variables over the remaining five years cluster in three categories.

First, oil price, which directly determines fiscal headroom and PIF funding capacity. Brent $70 is the base, $50-60 is downside risk, $90+ is upside. While Saudi Arabia is the OPEC+ leader, its unilateral control over oil price is limited — US shale, the speed of energy-transition substitution, and global demand recovery are all variables.

Second, reform pace. Accelerated Saudization can damage employment growth (replacement of expatriate workers can trigger short-term employment volatility), energy-subsidy reform can damage consumption (raising electricity, fuel, water prices), and overly-fast fiscal tightening can damage non-oil growth. The IMF-recommended "3.3% of non-oil GDP medium-term consolidation path" faces political-feasibility challenges.

Third, geopolitical shocks, including Iran conflict (especially the latent risk of Hormuz closure — Chatham House in May 2026 wrote that this poses a significant threat to Saudi exports (Chatham House 2026)), Trump 2.0 tariff policy (the IMF Annex IV assesses direct impact as limited, because 77% of Saudi exports to the US are oil products and already exempt (IMF 2025)), and OPEC+ internal fractures (UAE and other members may move further toward independent action).

Figure 34: 8 KPI groups vs 3 exogenous variables, sensitivity heatmap



Source: this study's composite judgement (based on IMF Article IV 2025 Annex VI Risk Assessment Matrix + Annex IV U.S. Tariff + Chatham House Iran 2026-05). Note: sensitivity scores are qualitative 0-5 range; not representative of the full IMF DSA quantitative conclusion.

Oil price is the single largest variable, but geopolitical shocks are a "left-tail risk" amplifier. They can simultaneously suppress oil prices (under risk-off sentiment, oil prices may fluctuate rather than rally), damage tourism (Saudi tourism is exposed to regional security), and compress FDI (the foreign-investor risk premium rises).

7.4 Investment view: which assets benefit or are damaged by the Vision 2030 endgame

For the reader's directional reference, this is not investment advice.

Beneficiaries. Saudi banks (SNB, Riyad, Al Rajhi etc.) benefit from FSDP policy dividends, credit expansion, and Saudization-driven credit demand. Tadawul-listed non-oil consumption, logistics, and building-materials leaders benefit from domestic consumption upgrade and infrastructure investment. Saudi sovereign debt (USD sovereign + sukuk) benefits from rating preservation (A+/Aa3) and spread attractiveness.

Neutral. Saudi Aramco is oil-price driven; Vision 2030 itself has limited direct impact on it. PIF overseas portfolio (Lucid Motors, Newcastle United, Magic Leap, etc.) faces domestic-funding pressure and reduced incremental allocation.

Adversely affected / uncertain. Pure Giga-project-exposed contractors (NEOM descope will trigger contract delays and re-pricing). Saudi-citizen wage-sensitive consumer goods (fiscal-tightening pressure slows public-sector wage growth).

Table 3: Saudi asset categories: beneficiary / neutral / adverse

Category	Sector / representative	Vision 2030 linkage	Trajectory
Beneficiary	Saudi banks (SNB / Riyad / Al Rajhi)	High (FSDP policy dividend)	Credit growth + rating preservation
Beneficiary	Non-oil consumption / logistics / building materials (Tadawul leaders)	High	Domestic consumption + regional hub
Beneficiary	Saudi debt (USD sovereign + sukuk)	Medium	Rating stability + spread attractive
Neutral	Saudi Aramco	Medium	Oil-price driven, limited upside
Neutral	PIF overseas portfolio (Lucid / some public holdings)	Medium	Domestic-funding pressure
Adverse	Pure Giga-project-exposed contractors	High	NEOM descope + contract-delay risk
Adverse	Saudi-citizen wage-sensitive consumer goods	Medium	Fiscal-tightening pressure

Source: this study's directional judgement. Note: research framework only, not investment advice; asset universe limited to public-market issues directly related to Vision 2030.

8 Conclusion

To paraphrase Carnegie's 2025 report: "Achievements clear, accountability limited, pace amplified in the narrative" (Carnegie Endowment for International Peace 2025).

Vision 2030 is a rare positive case of large-economy structural transformation in a developing-world setting. The female employment revolution (private × female +84%), social opening (tourism-visa liberalisation + Umrah expansion), financial-sector breakthroughs (multiple FSDP indicators past 2025 interim + Islamic 75% differentiation), and tourism-hub elevation (115.9M visitors, well past the 100M interim target) are all real reforms, and rank highly in international comparison. This is the "half done."

But "comprehensive build-out by 2030" was an over-promise from the start. NEOM and other Giga-projects have materially descoped (The Line's population target cut by 80%, as reported in media but not officially confirmed); the non-oil-exports / non-oil-GDP 50% target is almost unreachable from current 22.14%; the SME share of GDP at 35% target requires 50% further growth in five years (a historically rare pace); the private-sector contribution to GDP at 65% target is 14 ppts above the current 51%; FDI as a share of GDP at 5.7% target is 2.9 ppts above the current 2.8%. This is the "half deferred."

A deeper read: the Saudi government has, between 2025 and 2026, quietly completed a "target reset." The GDP rebasing lifted the headline non-oil share; the KPI architecture was reorganised from 96 to 390 KPIs + 1,290 initiatives; the unemployment target moved from 7% to 5%; PIF strategy shifted international share from the 30% baseline to actual 17% (with media reporting suggesting a new strategic target near 20%); NEOM was descoped. These are all "soft landing" mechanisms. Vision 2030 will not fail, but its actual end-state will look quite different from the 2016 announcement.

Three real tests over the remaining five years. First, whether the "soft landing" on NEOM and other Giga-projects proceeds smoothly, completing project descope without triggering sovereign credit downgrades or PIF credibility loss. Second, whether the three hardest structural KPIs — non-oil exports, SME share of GDP, private-sector GDP contribution — can break through before 2030; this likely needs to wait for a Vision 2040-style continuation. Third, whether the three exogenous variables (oil price, geopolitical shocks, reform pace) are friendly; Saudi self-control here is limited.

Finally, a line from Jane Kinninmont's 2017 Chatham House report serves as a footnote to this study: "Few observers believe Vision 2030 will meet its ambitious targets, but it has nonetheless defined the broad direction of economic travel" (Kinninmont 2017). What Vision 2030 has genuinely changed is the trajectory of Saudi Arabia, not the contents of its target list.

Appendix

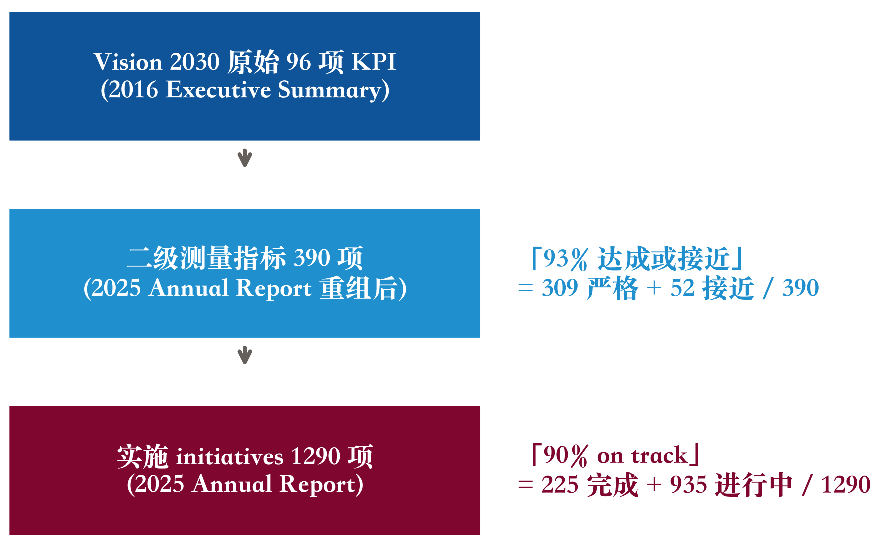
1. Vision 2030 KPI architecture, three-layer structure: 96 → 390 → 1,290

The Vision 2030 KPI architecture has been reorganised twice.

At launch in 2016, Vision 2030 set out 96 strategic objectives / KPIs (the figure is widely cited in contemporaneous media coverage and earlier-version Executive Summaries; the locally-held PDF is the 2025 reissue, and the 2016 original could not be directly verified) (Saudi Vision 2030 2016). This is the original architecture, and the basis of the "comprehensive build-out by 2030" narrative.

The 2025 Vision 2030 Annual Report reorganises the KPI architecture (Saudi Vision 2030 2026). Page 11 sets out the current architecture: first- and second-level indicators total 390 (of which 309 have strictly achieved, 52 are near, 29 are below 85%); implementation initiatives total 1,290 (of which 225 are completed, 935 are in progress, and the remainder are in preparation). The report gives two 90+% figures: "93% achieved or near annual target" (denominator: 390 KPIs) and "90% completed or on track" (denominator: 1,290 initiatives).

Figure 35: KPI three-layer structure



Source: Vision 2030 Executive Summary 2016 (96 KPI baseline); Vision 2030 Annual Report 2025 pages 11-12 (390 KPIs / 1,290 initiatives). Note: the two 90+

The two figures appear similar but have different denominators and thresholds, and must be specified when cited. This is a hard constraint laid out in the project-level CLAUDE.md.

Table 4: “93% vs 90%” denominator and threshold comparison

Figure	Denominator	Threshold	Meaning
93%	390 KPIs	≥ 85% near-achievement	“KPI achieved or on track”
79%	390 KPIs	≥ 100% strict achievement	True strict KPI achievement rate
90%	1,290 initiatives	Completed + in progress	“Project-level on track”
17%	1,290 initiatives	Completed (225)	True project-completion rate

Source: Vision 2030 Annual Report 2025 page 11. Note: 390 KPI numerator: 309 strict (≥100

2. GASTAT May 2025 GDP rebasing, accounting treatment

Technical detail is in §1.1; two supplementary points here.

First, the rebasing was an IMF-recommended action over multiple 2019-2024 technical-assistance missions (IMF 2025). The 2018 base previously used by Saudi Arabia had aged (standard practice is to rebase every 5 years); the new 2023 base is a reasonable choice. The methodology change was adopted at the beginning of 2024 internally, and the full chain-linked Annual National Accounts release was published in May 2025.

Second, the rebasing result (nominal GDP +14%, non-oil GDP +20%) is consistent in direction and magnitude with IMF expectations. The upward revision is not “number juggling”; it reflects actual structural change in the Saudi economy between 2018 and 2023 (VAT introduction, tourism-sector rise, PIF subsidiary scale-up, financial-sector deepening).

That said: the revision moved the IMF same-methodology “non-oil share of GDP” from roughly 72% to 76% (including net taxes on products). A 4-percentage-point same-methodology upward revision is statistically defensible, but the coexistence of a “cross-source 30.7 ppt” range makes it easy for media to compress this into a single “50% to 76%” narrative, misleading readers. This is the focus of §1.1.

3. Four-source data caliper gaps, six core indicators

Table 5: Four-source data caliper gaps

Indicator	IMF	GASTAT	SAMA	Vision 2030 official	Note
Non-oil GDP share (%)	76	80.6 (nominal)	49.9 (2023)	~55 (media)	4-source 30.7 ppt span
Real GDP growth 2024 (%)	2.0	2.7 (post-rebase)	1.8	1.8	Rebasing effect
Non-oil GDP growth 2024 (%)	4.5	6.0 (post-rebase)	4.4 (2023)	4.5	Rebasing effect
Fiscal breakeven ($/bbl)	92	—	—	—	4-source $92-$111
Public debt 2025 (% GDP)	29.8	—	—	31.7 (MoF)	MoF vs IMF gap 1.9 ppt
KPI achievement (%)	—	—	—	93 (including near)	Strict only 79%

Source: IMF Article IV 2025 + GASTAT National Accounts 2024 + SAMA FSR 2024 + Vision 2030 Annual Report 2025 + MoF FY 2026 Budget. Note: the same indicator differs materially across calipers; when citing any single figure, the caliper must be specified.

The largest gap is in KPI achievement (79% strict vs 93% including near) and fiscal breakeven ($92 excluding PIF vs $111 including PIF). The smallest gap is in real GDP growth (post-rebasing converged) and public debt (MoF and IMF close).

4. This report's data-source selection rules

For each core indicator, the principle is "source with deepest expertise" as the primary responsible source.

Table 6: This report’s data-source selection rules

Indicator	Primary source	Cross-check source	Caliper rule
Real GDP / non-oil GDP growth (high-frequency)	GASTAT quarterly	IMF Article IV annual	Specify base year
Fiscal deficit / debt	IMF Article IV	MoF Budget	Dual-source side-by-side
Fiscal breakeven	IMF Article IV	Bloomberg / JPM	Specify caliper range
Foreign reserves	IMF Article IV (NFA)	MoF (govt deposit)	Not interchangeable
Banking indicators	SAMA FSDP / FSR	IMF FSAP	SAMA primary, IMF check
KPI achievement	Vision 2030 AR	Media / independent assessment	Must show dual caliper
Giga-projects progress	GS Capex 2023 (baseline) + MEED (current)	Bloomberg / FT	Specify time-point
PIF data	PIF AR / FS	Media restatement	Specify pre vs post rebasing
Academic / think-tank views	IMF WP / Chatham House / Carnegie	—	Framework only, not data

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